

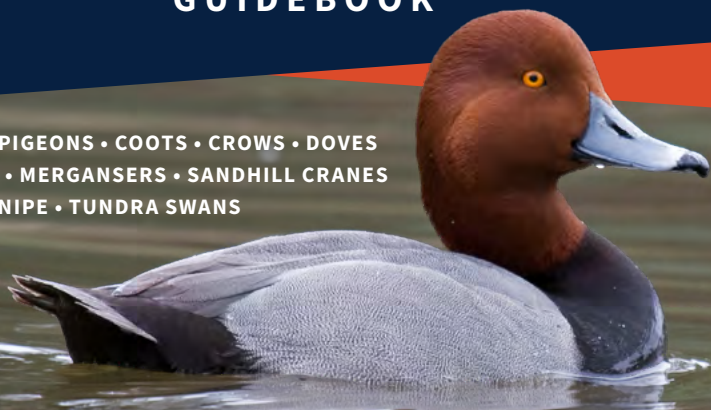


Wildlife Resources

WATERFOWL, UPLAND GAME and TURKEY

GUIDEBOOK

**BAND-TAILED PIGEONS • COOTS • CROWS • DOVES
DUCKS • GEESE • MERGANSERS • SANDHILL CRANES
SNIPES • TUNDRA SWANS**



**GROUSE • HARES • PARTRIDGE
PHEASANTS • PTARMIGAN • QUAIL • RABBITS**



TURKEYS



2026-27

Know the laws

This guidebook summarizes Utah's hunting laws and rules for upland game, turkey, and waterfowl and other migratory game birds. Although it is a convenient quick-reference document for Utah's regulations, it is not an all-encompassing resource.

For more information and an in-depth look at the state's upland game and migratory game bird hunting rules, visit wildlife.utah.gov/rules.

You can use the references in the guidebook—such as *Utah Code § 23A-5-309* and *Utah Admin. Rules R657-9-6* and *R657-9-4*—to find the detailed law or rule that underpins the guidebook summary.

If you have questions about a particular rule, call or visit the nearest DWR office.

Who makes the rules?

The Utah Wildlife Board passes the rules summarized in this guidebook.

There are seven board members, and each serves a six-year term. Appointed by the governor, board members are not division employees.

The division's director serves as the board's executive secretary but does not have a vote on wildlife policies.

Before board members make changes to wildlife rules, they listen to recommendations from division biologists. They also receive input from the public and various interest groups via the regional advisory council (RAC) process.

If you have feedback or suggestions for board members, you can find their contact information online at wildlife.utah.gov.

Wildlife Board members

Bob Christensen	Gary Nielson, <i>Chair</i>
Ryan Foutz	Paula Richmond, <i>Vice Chair</i>
Kent Johnson	Riley Peck, <i>Division Director</i>
Justin Oliver	& <i>Executive Secretary</i>
Chris Robinson	

Contact us

Report wildlife crimes

Phone: 800-662-3337

Text: 847411

Online: wildlife.utah.gov/utip

Division offices

Offices are open 8 a.m.–5 p.m.,
Monday through Friday.

Salt Lake City

1594 W North Temple

Box 146301

Salt Lake City, UT 84116

801-538-4700

Central Region

1115 N Main Street

Springville, UT 84663

801-491-5678

Northeastern Region

318 N Vernal Avenue

Vernal, UT 84078

435-781-9453

Northern Region

515 E 5300 S

Ogden, UT 84405

801-476-2740

Southeastern Region

319 N Carbonville Road, Ste A

Price, UT 84501

435-613-3700

Southern Region

1470 N Airport Road

Cedar City, UT 84721

435-865-6100

Washington County Field Office

451 N SR-318

Hurricane, UT 84737

435-879-8694

Connect with us:



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What's new?

Combined waterfowl (and other migratory game birds), upland game and turkey guidebook: Utah's requirements and field regulations for hunting upland game and migratory game birds (including waterfowl) are very similar, and many of these species' seasons and hunting areas overlap. To consolidate information for hunters, the division combined these guidebooks beginning this year. Specific instances where federal and state regulations differ by species—such as duck stamp and Harvest Information Program (HIP) requirements, and nontoxic shot regulations—are noted throughout.

Apply for tundra swan, crane and grouse hunts with the NEW online draw system: If you plan to apply for tundra swan, sandhill crane, greater sage-grouse and sharp-tailed grouse permits in the hunt drawing, the application period runs from June 30–July 14, 2026. Visit utahdraws.com (the new URL starting this year), or call the new draw hotline at 855-883-7297 to apply.

Wild turkey harvest reporting now required: The Utah Wildlife Board approved mandatory harvest reporting for wild turkey (for both spring and fall seasons) beginning with the fall 2026 season. If you obtain a fall management or spring turkey permit (general season or limited entry) of any kind, you must complete a harvest report **within 30 days of the end of your hunt season**—even if you did not harvest a bird—or you will not be able to apply in the next limited-entry turkey application unless you complete a harvest report and pay a \$25 late fee.

Permit required for band-tailed pigeon and white-tailed ptarmigan: Beginning July 30, 2026 at 8 a.m. MDT, you can obtain the free permit required for hunting band-tailed pigeons and white-tailed ptarmigan. Permits are available at wildlife.utah.gov and from license agents and DWR offices.

Youth hunts: Eligible hunters who are 17 years old or younger on July 31, 2026 may participate in Utah's youth hunts for some waterfowl and upland bird species. (A permit is required for the youth wild turkey hunt.) See the table on page 13 for species and dates.

White-fronted geese bag and possession limit decrease: Hunters may take 6 white-fronted geese each day, with a possession limit of 18. (This is a reduction from last year.) To see bag and possession limits for all geese, see page 65.

Brief WMA closures for sponsored pheasant hunts: Some wildlife and waterfowl management areas are closed to the general public each year for sponsored, organized youth and beginner pheasant hunts. Closures this year:

- Oct. 31—Gordon Creek WMA (upper fields)
- Nov. 14—Annabella, Pahvant and Pine Canyon WMAs, and a portion of the Ogden Bay WMA

See wildlife.utah.gov/uplandgame/youth later this summer for more details.

Electronic tagging option for tundra swan and turkey: Hunters can now submit an e-tag through the Utah Hunting and Fishing app if they harvest a tundra swan or turkey. It's the same as notching a paper tag, and fulfills physical check-in and mandatory harvest requirements upon completion. Review important permit carry requirements on page 30 and e-tagging methods on page 46 before you go into the field. Learn more about this convenient new option at wildlife.utah.gov/e-tag.

Digital permit or license required to access some WMAs: The Utah Legislature passed a law requiring anyone 18 years old or older to have a free Utah WMA digital access permit or a valid hunting, fishing or combination license to access waterfowl and wildlife management areas in Utah's four largest counties (Davis, Salt Lake, Utah and Weber). This requirement will be phased in at WMAs statewide over the next three years. The requirement applies to adults accessing a WMA for hunting or other recreational purposes. WMAs are primarily funded by the sales of Utah hunting, fishing and combination licenses and by federal excise taxes paid on hunting and fishing equipment; typically, state taxes do not pay for them. Visit wildlife.utah.gov/wmas for details.

Find updated maps, boundaries and permit numbers: Use the Utah Hunt Planner to find maps, boundaries and information for your hunts this year. Visit hunt.utah.gov or see the information box on page 9.

Protect wildlife by reporting suspected wildlife crimes



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at wildlife.utah.gov/utip



Your Utah Hunting and Fishing mobile app: The app makes it easy to download, read, search and navigate this guidebook and others. You can also keep your hunting or combo license, and any DWR course completion certificates on the app. Learn more about the app and download it at wildlife.utah.gov/mobileapp. **Note:** You must still carry your printed permit with you in the field if you intend to tag your harvested animal with a paper tag.

Hunting outfitters and guides: Guides and outfitters in Utah are regulated by the DWR (instead of the Department of Professional Licensing) as approved by the Utah Legislature last year. In the 2026 session, the legislature removed several requirements for spotters, and amended some for outfitters and guides. If you are a guide or outfitter, visit wildlife.utah.gov/guides for updated application, registration and other operational requirements.

New deadline for medical refund applications: If you are eligible for a refund, you must submit all required forms and accompanying paperwork within 30 days of the season ending in order to qualify for a full refund. (Previously, this deadline was 90 days.) See page 22 for details.

Commercial hunting area buffer zone: The requirement for a 1/4-mile buffer between commercial hunting areas and wildlife/waterfowl management areas has been lifted as approved by the board.

Season date changes: Season dates change every year, so please check them carefully before you head out on your hunt. You can find season dates listed on your permit or at hunt.utah.gov.

Important reminders

Quick reference guide for duck stamp and HIP requirements: Unsure if you need to purchase a duck stamp or obtain a HIP number this season? Check the quick-reference tables on pages 10-11 for more information. See page 16 for duck stamp requirements and purchase options, or visit wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl for details.

Online HIP registration process: You must have a Migratory Game Bird Harvest Information Program (HIP) number issued between March 11, 2026 and March 10, 2027 if you plan to hunt waterfowl and other migratory game birds during the 2026–2027 season. Free registration is at wildlife.utah.gov/uthip. For more information, see page 16.

Turkey hunt boundaries: Make sure to check the boundaries for your turkey hunt before you go into the field. See the map on page 71 or visit hunt.utah.gov for details.

Swan course: Hunters must complete the swan identification orientation course each year before they apply for a tundra swan permit or a preference point. For details, see page 13 or wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl.

Trumpeter swan rules: Taking trumpeter swans is illegal in Utah. Intentionally or unintentionally taken trumpeter swans will be seized by law enforcement, and criminal penalties may apply. See the information box page 61 for details about this rule and potential penalties.

Harmful algal blooms: In recent years, Utah has experienced recurring toxic algal blooms, which can be fatal for dogs. Visit habs.utah.gov for details.

Wildlife diseases in Utah: Highly pathogenic avian influenza viruses are typically uncommon in Utah game birds, but there have been more widespread, multicounty outbreaks in recent years (see page 52). Rabbit hemorrhagic disease has also been confirmed in Utah. For more information about these and other wildlife diseases, visit wildlife.utah.gov/diseases.

Stay informed: We will communicate changes that may affect you and your hunt via email and social media. Visit wildlife.utah.gov/stayconnected to sign up for email updates and follow us on social media channels.

Technology rules: Night-vision devices, drones, and recorded or electronically amplified bird calls or sounds are prohibited in hunting protected wildlife (see exceptions for some late-season waterfowl hunts on page 43). For details about trail camera and night-vision device rules, see the information box on page 41 or visit wildlife.utah.gov/trailcams.

No dog training near grouse leks: Dog training is prohibited within 1/2 mile of sage-grouse and sharp-tailed grouse leks (breeding sites) from March 1 to May 31.

AIS requirements for all boaters: To prevent the destructive spread of quagga mussels and invasive plants like watermilfoil, both resident and nonresident boaters have Aquatic Invasive Species program annual requirements prior to launch in Utah's waters. Learn more about these requirements and how to decontaminate your watercraft at STDOfttheSea.utah.gov.

No permanent blinds on WMAs: Individuals may not construct permanent blinds on waterfowl management areas. For more information about using blinds, see page 55.

Credit card processing fee: In order to cover our increasing costs for systems and electronic payment processing, the DWR began charging a 2.2% processing fee on all credit card transactions as of July 1, 2024. (The Utah Legislature authorized a fee up to 3% to cover these costs.)

Discounted licenses for disabled veterans: The DWR offers discounted hunting and combination licenses to Utah veterans who were disabled in the line of duty. For details, see page 10.

Do not transport phragmites and other noxious weeds: A species of non-native, invasive phragmites plants has aggressively expanded throughout Utah, . It is illegal to transport uncontained weed seeds, which may be present on phragmites stalks attached to watercraft as blind material. See *Utah Admin. Rule R68-9-4* for details.

Guidebook corrections: If errors are found in this guidebook after it is published, the DWR will correct them in the digital edition. Visit wildlife.utah.gov/guidebooks or the DWR mobile app to view digital versions of all the DWR's guidebooks.

Protection from discrimination: This agency receives federal financial assistance from the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service. Under Title VI of the 1964 Civil Rights Act, Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, the Age Discrimination Act of 1975, and Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, the U.S. Department of the Interior prohibits discrimination on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, age, sex, or disability. If you believe that you have been discriminated against in any facility, program, or activity, or if you need more information, please write to:

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1849 C Street, NW
Washington, D.C. 20250

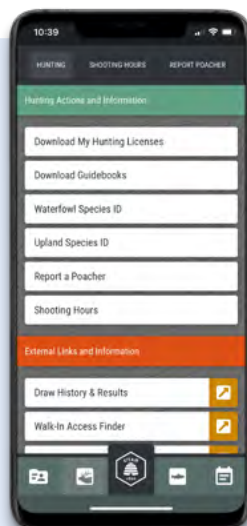
Private lands: The DWR cannot guarantee access to any private land. You must obtain documented permission from the landowner or the landowner's authorized representative before hunting on private lands. For more information, please see *Trespassing* on page 38.

Division funding: The division is mostly funded by the sale of hunting and fishing licenses and through federal aid made possible by an excise tax on the sale of firearms and other hunting- and fishing-related equipment.

Do more with the Utah Hunting and Fishing mobile app

In the app you can download and save:

- Your hunting or combo license, and licenses for family members
- Utah's hunting and fishing guidebooks
- Any DWR course completion certificates
- Your Walk-in Access authorization number
- New this year, download your tundra swan or turkey permit and submit an on-site e-tag (which completes the mandatory harvest survey requirement)



Learn more and download the app at wildlife.utah.gov/mobileapp.

Key dates and fees

Application and purchase dates

Sandhill crane, tundra swan and grouse* permit application dates

Apply online	June 30, 2026
Application deadline	July 14, 2026
Drawing results available	July 23, 2026
Remaining permits available	Aug. 6, 2026

**Greater sage-grouse, sharp-tailed grouse*

Turkey application and purchase dates

Fall 2026 management harvest permits available	Sept. 10, 2026
Limited-entry applications available online	Dec. 15, 2026
Application deadline	Dec. 29, 2026
Drawing results available	Jan. 7, 2027
Remaining limited-entry permits available	March 11, 2027
Spring general-season permits available	March 11, 2027

Permit and application fees

For a complete list of Utah’s license and permit fees, visit wildlife.utah.gov/fees.
A 2.2% transaction fee applies to all online and in-person credit/debit card transactions.

Type of permit	Resident	Nonresident
Band-tailed pigeon permit	\$0	\$0
White-tailed ptarmigan permit	\$0	\$0
Sandhill crane permit^	\$40	\$175
Tundra swan permit^	\$40	\$175
Greater sage-grouse permit*	\$0	\$0
Sharp-tailed grouse permit*	\$0	\$0
Turkey limited-entry permit^	\$40	\$175
Turkey general-season permit	\$40	\$175
Turkey general-season permit (youth)	\$25	n/a
CWMU turkey permit^	\$40	\$175
Application fee	\$10	\$21

**There is a nonrefundable application and handling fee to obtain this permit.*
^There is a nonrefundable application fee if you apply for this permit through the hunt drawing. If you obtain a permit that remains available after the drawing, the application fee does not apply.

Duck stamp

A federal migratory bird hunting and conservation stamp (commonly known as a duck stamp) is required for waterfowl hunters 16 years of age and older. The stamp is \$25, and additional transaction fees may apply. See page 16 for details and purchase options.

License fees

For a complete list of Utah’s license and permit fees, visit wildlife.utah.gov/fees. A 2.2% fee will apply for all online and in-person credit/debit card transactions.

License type	Age	Resident	Nonresident
365-day hunting license	13 and under	\$11	\$44
	14–17	\$16	\$44
	18–64	\$40	\$144
	65+	\$31	\$144
365-day hunting license for disabled veterans (see the box on page 11 for details)	n/a	\$25.50	n/a
Multi-year hunting license (up to five years)	18-64	\$39 / year	\$143 / year
365-day combination* license	17 and under	\$20	\$58
	18–64	\$44	\$190
	65+	\$35	\$190
365-day combination* license for disabled veterans (see the box on page 11 for details)	n/a	\$28.50	n/a
Multi-year combination* license (up to five years)	18-64	\$43 / year	\$189 / year

* A combination license allows you to hunt or fish in Utah.

Three-day nonresident small game license

If you’re not a resident of Utah and you’ll only be in the state for a short time, you can hunt waterfowl and upland game without paying the full price for a nonresident license. A three-day nonresident small game license is available for \$89. You can purchase a three-day small game license online at wildlife.utah.gov or from license agents and division offices.

Note: A three-day license does not allow you to apply for or obtain any Utah hunting permits.

Boundary maps online

Looking for a map of your hunting area? Maps of all hunt boundaries, species distributions, Walk-in Access areas and wildlife management areas are available at hunt.utah.gov. You also have the option of using the Utah Hunting and Fishing app to view the boundaries of any permits you’ve drawn. To download the app, visit wildlife.utah.gov/mobileapp.

2026–27 season dates

These tables are intended as a quick-reference guide. For exact season dates, hunting areas, and bag and possession limits, see pages 69-73. For information about falconry, see page 44.

Waterfowl and other migratory game birds

If you plan to hunt migratory game birds, you'll need a Utah hunting or combination license. Additionally, federal and state requirements vary depending on which species you'll be hunting. Some species require that you obtain a permit, register in the Harvest Information Program (all ages) or purchase a federal migratory bird hunting and conservation stamp (aka duck stamp, required for waterfowl hunters age 16 and older). See page 18 to learn more about obtaining a permit, and page 16 for HIP number and duck stamp details.

Species	Season dates	Requirement		
		Permit	Duck stamp	HIP
American crow	Sept. 1–30, 2026 and Dec. 1, 2026–Feb. 28, 2027			X
Band-tailed pigeon	Sept. 1–14, 2026	X		X
Mourning dove and white-winged dove	Sept. 1–Oct. 30, 2026			X
Sandhill crane	Dates vary by area; see page 68	X		X
Tundra swan	Oct. 3–Dec. 13, 2026	X	X	X
Duck, merganser, coot and snipe—Northern Zone*	Oct. 3, 2026–Jan. 16, 2027		X	X
Duck, merganser, coot and snipe—Southern Zone*	Oct. 10, 2026–Jan. 23, 2027		X	X
Scaup—Northern Zone	Oct. 3–Dec. 27, 2026		X	X
Scaup—Southern Zone	Oct. 30, 2026–Jan. 23, 2027		X	X
Dark^ and white-fronted geese—Eastern Box Elder goose area	Oct. 3, 2026–Jan. 16, 2027		X	X
Dark^ and white-fronted geese—Northern goose area	Oct. 3–10, 2026 and Oct. 26, 2026–Jan. 31, 2027		X	X
Dark^ and white-fronted geese—Southern goose area	Oct. 10, 2026–Jan. 23, 2027		X	X
Dark^ and white-fronted geese—Wasatch Front goose area	Oct. 3–10, 2026 and Nov. 10, 2026–Feb. 15, 2027		X	X
Light geese**—Eastern Box Elder, Northern and Wasatch Front goose areas	Oct. 15–Dec. 22, 2026 and Feb. 1–March 10, 2027		X	X
Light geese**—Southern goose area	Oct. 26–Dec. 15, 2026 and Jan. 15–March 10, 2027		X	X

*See page 12 for youth hunt dates and other details.

^Dark geese are any cackling, Canada or brant geese.

**Light geese are snow, blue or Ross's geese.

Discounted licenses for disabled veterans

The division offers discounted hunting and combination licenses to Utah servicemembers who were disabled in the line of duty.

The discounted hunting license is \$25.50, instead of the \$40 full price. Likewise, the discounted combination license is \$28.50, instead of the \$44 full price. Either license is good for 365 days from the day you buy it. Discounted licenses are available online or from all division offices listed on page 2.

To purchase a discounted hunting or combination license, you must be a Utah resident and have a qualifying

service-connected disability of at least 20 percent.

To apply for a license online, please visit wildlife.utah.gov/accessibility/veteran and complete the online form. If you need assistance, please call the nearest division office.

If you choose to visit a division office to purchase your license, simply bring the verification of service-connected disability documentation that the Department of Veterans Affairs issued to you.

You can find additional resources for hunters and anglers with disabilities at wildlife.utah.gov/accessibility.

Upland game and turkey

If you plan to hunt upland game or turkey, you'll need a Utah hunting or combination license, and you must obtain a permit to hunt some upland game bird species. (See page 18 for information about grouse and ptarmigan permits, and page 24 for turkey permits.) However, you **do not** need to register in the Harvest Information Program (HIP) or obtain a duck stamp to hunt any species listed in the table below.

Species	Season dates	Permit required
White-tailed ptarmigan	Sept. 1–Oct. 31, 2026	X
Dusky and ruffed grouse	Sept. 1–Dec. 31, 2026	
Cottontail rabbit	Sept. 1, 2026–Feb. 28, 2027	
Snowshoe hare	Sept. 1, 2026–March 15, 2027	
Jackrabbit	year-round	
Greater sage-grouse	Sept. 26–Oct. 18, 2026	X
Sharp-tailed grouse	Sept. 26–Oct. 18, 2026	X
Chukar and gray (Hungarian) partridge	Sept. 26, 2026–Feb. 15, 2027	
Ring-necked pheasant	Nov. 7–Dec. 6, 2026	
California and Gambel's quail	Nov. 7–Dec. 31, 2026	
Turkey, fall management harvest hunts	Oct. 1, 2026–Feb. 28, 2027	X
Turkey, spring limited-entry hunts	April 10–29, 2027	X
Turkey, spring general-season hunts	May 3–31, 2027	X

Utah's youth waterfowl, upland game bird and turkey hunts

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-31 and R657-6-24

Utah's youth hunts are open to all youth who have a valid hunting or combination license (and permit, if applicable). To participate in these hunts:

- You must be 17 years of age or younger on July 31, 2026.
- If you are under the age of 16, you must be accompanied by a person 21 years of age or older who has been approved by your parent or legal guardian.
- You may hunt only in the areas and boundaries allowable for the youth hunt by species (see hunt.utah.gov for details); trespassing rules apply.
- All waterfowl hunters, regardless of age, must register for a HIP number prior to going into the field. If you are a waterfowl hunter 16 years of age or older, you must also purchase a federal duck stamp.
- If you are a falconer, you may **not** participate in this hunt unless you meet the age requirements.

Important: If you plan to hunt Utah's national wildlife refuges during the Youth Waterfowl Hunts, keep in mind that Bear River and Ouray are in the Northern Zone (Sept. 19) and Fish Springs is in the Southern Zone (Sept. 26). For details, see pages 56-58.

New: The bag limit for white-fronted geese has **decreased** from 10 birds to 6 birds.

Tundra swan course requirement: Regardless of age, hunters must complete the annual swan orientation course each year before applying for a tundra swan permit or preference point. The course is available online at wildlife.utah.gov/swancourse and takes about 30 minutes to complete.

Youth pheasant hunts: A few sponsored youth and beginner pheasant hunts will be offered during the upland game season. For more information, visit wildlife.utah.gov/uplandgame/youth.

Youth turkey hunts: For details about youth turkey hunts, see the information box on page 28.

Utah's Trial Hunting Program

Utah Admin. Rule R657-68

Have you ever wanted to bring your spouse, child or friend along on a hunt and give them a chance to try hunting? Now, they can join you on your next waterfowl or upland game hunt.

Utah's Trial Hunting Program allows anyone age 12 or older to try hunting for up to three years—while accompanied by a licensed hunter over the age of 21—before taking a Hunter Education course.

The program applies to hunts for many different species, including waterfowl, upland game and turkey. To sign up for the program or to learn more about it, visit wildlife.utah.gov/trial.

Species	Youth hunt dates	Daily bag limits	Requirement		
			Permit	Duck stamp	HIP
Waterfowl: Northern Zone*	Sept. 19, 2026	- Ducks and mergansers: 7 birds except no more than: › 2 canvasbacks › 2 hen mallards › 3 pintail › 2 redheads › 2 wood ducks › 2 scaup		X	X
Waterfowl: Southern Zone*	Sept. 26, 2026	- Coots: 25 birds - Dark geese (cackling, Canada and brant): 5 birds - White-fronted geese: 6 birds		X	X
Tundra swan (Northern Zone only)	Sept. 19, 2026	1 bird	X	X	X
Chukar and gray (Hungarian) partridge	Sept. 19–21, 2026	5 birds (15 in possession)			
California and Gambel's quail	Oct. 31–Nov. 2, 2026	5 birds (15 in possession)			
Ring-necked pheasant	Oct. 31–Nov. 5, 2026	2 male birds (6 male birds in possession)			
Turkey, spring general-season	April 30–May 2, 2027	1 bird	X		

***Closed for youth hunt:** Youth may not hunt the following species during the Youth Waterfowl Hunt in either zone:

- Any light geese (snow, blue and Ross's)
- Snipe
- Sandhill crane
- Crows, pigeons and doves

Check shooting hours and boundaries before you go into the field

Shooting hours apply. See the tables beginning on page 74 for shooting hours on the date(s) you are hunting.

Refer to the Utah Hunt Planner (hunt.utah.gov) for zone and area boundaries.

Basic requirements

Are you planning to hunt upland game, wild turkey or migratory game birds in Utah this year? Before you head into the field, make sure you meet Utah's hunter education and license requirements. Additionally, if you are hunting migratory game birds you must register for a Migratory Bird Harvest Information Program (HIP) number, and you will also need a federal migratory bird hunting and conservation stamp (duck stamp) to hunt waterfowl if you are 16 or older. This section explains how to meet these requirements.

Are you old enough?

Utah Code § 23A-4-1001

In Utah, there are no age restrictions for upland game, turkey or migratory game bird hunters. If you have passed a division-approved hunter education course, you can hunt these small game species in Utah, regardless of your age. You are considered to be a youth hunter if you are 17 years old or younger on July 31, 2026.

Adults must accompany young hunters

Utah Code § 23A-4-708

While hunting with any weapon, a person under 14 years old must be accompanied by their parent, legal guardian or other responsible person who is 21 years of age or older and who has been approved by the parent or guardian.

A person at least 14 years old and under 16 years old must be accompanied by a person 21 years of age or older while hunting with any weapon.

The division encourages adults to be familiar with hunter education guidelines or to complete the hunter education course before accompanying youth into the field.

While in the field, the youth and the adult must remain close enough for the adult to see and provide verbal assistance to the young hunter. Using electronic devices, such as two-way radios or cell phones, does not meet this requirement.

Is hunter education required?

Utah Code § 23A-4-1001 & Utah Admin. Rule R657-23

If you were born after Dec. 31, 1965, you must provide proof that you've passed a hunter education course approved by the DWR before you can apply for or obtain a hunting license or any permit.

The only exception to this law is for individuals who are participating in the DWR's Trial Hunting Program. You can find details about the program on the next page or by visiting wildlife.utah.gov/trialhunting.

Proof of hunter education

You can prove that you've completed hunter education by obtaining a hunter education card (called a "blue card" in Utah) or if you have a verified hunter education number on file with the division. The number is assigned when you complete hunter education and your blue card is issued.

How to take hunter education

To get started, you should visit wildlife.utah.gov/huntereducation. You'll see links to various traditional and online hunter education courses. Follow the instructions on the website to obtain a hunter education registration certificate (required) and to register for a course online.

If you need assistance, please contact your local DWR office or call 801-538-4727.

When you finish the course, your instructor will verify your course completion in the online hunter education system. At that point, you will be able to apply for or obtain permits in the division's hunt drawing, and your hunter education registration certificate will become your hunting license.

Approximately four to six weeks after you complete the course, you will receive your blue card by mail. You should also keep the following in mind:

- Hunters under the age of 16 must be accompanied by an adult while hunting.
- All hunting regulations, including season dates and bag limits, will apply.
- Hunters who are planning to hunt out of state should allow enough time for their hunter education card to arrive in the mail.

New to Utah?

If you become a Utah resident—and you've completed an approved hunter education course in another state, province or country—you must transfer your certification to the division before you can buy a resident hunting license or be eligible to purchase a resident hunting permit. You can provide proof that you've completed a nationally recognized hunter education course at any DWR office, or by submitting the online form at wildlife.utah.gov/huntereducation/transfer.

Do you have a license?

Utah Code §§ 23A-4-201 and 23A-5-309, and Utah Admin. Rule R657-54a-3

Before you can hunt upland game or migratory game birds in Utah you must possess a valid hunting license or combination license. You must also have one of these licenses before you can apply for or obtain a permit to hunt sandhill crane, tundra swan, greater sage-grouse, sharp-tailed grouse, band-tailed pigeon, white-tailed ptarmigan or wild turkey.

Here's the difference between the two licenses:

- A hunting license allows you to hunt small game, including migratory game birds and upland game.
- A combination license allows you to fish and hunt small game in Utah. When you buy a combination license, you also get a price break compared to buying your hunting and fishing licenses separately.

To purchase a license, visit wildlife.utah.gov or call 801-538-4700. You can also visit a license agent or any DWR office.

Remember: There are restrictions on fishing and hunting license purchasers for nonpayment of child support. For additional information—or to arrange a payment schedule—please contact the Office of Recovery Services at 801-536-8500.

You must carry your license with you while you're hunting, and you cannot alter your license, or transfer or lend it to another person. Keep in mind that you can also use the Utah Hunting and Fishing app to legally carry hunting or combination licenses on a phone or tablet for all the members of your family. To download the app, visit wildlife.utah.gov/mobileapp.

Do you need a federal stamp?

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-4

If you plan to hunt waterfowl, in addition to your hunting license you must obtain a federal migratory bird hunting and conservation stamp if you're 16 years of age or older. This stamp is commonly referred to as a duck stamp.

Either a traditional (printed) duck stamp or electronic (digital) duck stamp must be purchased each year before you go into the field to hunt. Duck stamps are valid July 1 through June 30 each hunting season.

Here are your options:

- **Printed stamp:** Purchase a physical (printed) duck stamp from your local post office, some license agents or by phone at 800-782-6724. **Note:** Duck stamps are not available at division offices. After you buy a physical duck stamp, you must validate it by signing your name in ink across the face of the stamp. You must also carry your stamp with you while you're hunting (most hunters place their stamp on the back of their hunting license).
- **E-stamp and DWR app download:** Purchase an electronic duck stamp through the division website (wildlife.utah.gov). If you purchase an e-duck stamp through the DWR website, you can download it to your Utah Hunting and Fishing app to show proof of purchase.
- **Duckstamp.com and digital wallet download:** Purchase an electronic duck stamp through the third party vendor Amplex at duckstamp.com. If you purchase an e-duck stamp from Amplex, you can download it to your Google or Apple wallet. (Downloading it to the DWR app is not an option.)

Important: To determine if you'll need a duck stamp, review the species tables on pages 10 and 11.

Note: If you purchase an electronic duck stamp, you'll receive a printed stamp in the mail after the migratory game birds season ends (after March 1), and the stamp will have an e-duck stamp watermark.

If you're 15 years of age or younger, you do not need a federal duck stamp to hunt migratory game birds, but if you turn 16 during the season, you must buy a stamp to hunt the remainder of the season.

Do you have a HIP number?

50 CFR 20.20 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-3

If you are hunting migratory game birds (see a list of species on page 10), in addition to your license—and a duck stamp, if required—you must obtain a Migratory Game Bird Harvest Information Program (HIP) registration number every season. See the quick-reference tables on pages 10-11 to determine if the species you are planning to hunt requires HIP.

The number you obtained last season is not valid for this season.

HIP numbers for the 2026–2027 season are valid March 11, 2026 through March 10, 2027.

A mobile-friendly process

To obtain a Utah HIP number, just visit wildlife.utah.gov/uthip online and complete a few brief questions.

You will need to provide information about migratory game bird hunts you participated in during the 2025–2026 season.

When you complete the registration process, your new HIP number will appear on the screen. You can also choose to have it emailed to you.

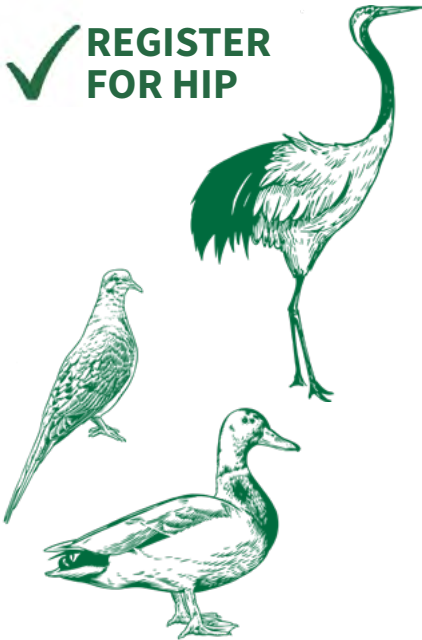
If you need help while registering for a HIP number, or cannot apply for one online, please contact any division office (see page 2) from Mon.–Fri., 8 a.m.–5 p.m.

Once you’ve obtained your HIP number, you must write the number in the space provided on your current hunting license.

You can also enter and save your HIP number on the Utah Hunting and Fishing app. The app is available at wildlife.utah.gov/mobileapp.



The **Harvest Information Program (HIP)** is a legally required certification for migratory game bird hunters that helps biologists manage migratory birds. Learn more about federal migratory bird surveys at fws.gov.



Register for HIP if you intend to hunt migratory birds such as ducks, geese, brant, tundra swans, doves, American crows, band-tailed pigeons, cranes, coots and snipe.

Do not register for HIP if you do not intend to hunt migratory birds.

How to obtain permits for migratory and upland game birds

If you meet the basic hunting requirements (pages 14-17), you will need an additional permit to hunt some upland game and migratory bird species before you head into the field. This section outlines the types of permits available, and explains how to apply for or obtain them. You'll also find information about group applications, preference points and the youth hunt drawing. For detailed information about obtaining wild turkey permits, see pages 24-29.

Types of permits

Utah Code §§ 23A-4-201 and 23A-5-309, and Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-4 and R657-6-5

You must obtain a permit if you want to hunt the following species:

- Band-tailed pigeon (free permit for reporting purposes)
- Sandhill crane (a one-bird permit)
- Tundra swan (a one-bird permit)
- Greater sage-grouse (a two-bird permit)
- Sharp-tailed grouse (a two-bird permit)
- White-tailed ptarmigan (free permit for reporting purposes)

For each of the above species, you may only obtain one permit.

Important: For details about obtaining wild turkey permits, see pages 24-29.

Obtaining over the counter permits

Band-tailed pigeon and white-tailed ptarmigan permits are available at wildlife.utah.gov, license agents and DWR offices, beginning July 30 at 8 a.m. MDT. You must have a valid hunting or combination license before purchasing one of these types of permits. A three-day small game license cannot be used to purchase one of these permits.

Prepare to apply for a permit

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-22

You must have a valid Utah hunting or combination license before you can apply for or obtain a permit for the species listed above. You must also have a valid hunting or combination license in order to hunt any upland game or migratory game bird species. If your hunting license expires before the hunting season ends, you'll have to buy a new license to hunt the remainder of the season.

Reminder: There are restrictions on fishing and hunting license purchasers for nonpayment of child support. For additional information—or to arrange a payment schedule—please contact the Office of Recovery Services at 801-536-8500.

Residency

Utah Code § 23A-1-101

If applying as a Utah resident, you must be a resident as of the day you submit your application. (Please see the definition of *Resident* on page 79 to learn whether you qualify.)

Complete the annual swan orientation course

Course required: The swan orientation course must be completed each year before you apply for a tundra swan permit or preference point.

The course is available online at wildlife.utah.gov/swancourse and takes about 30 minutes to complete.

The swan orientation course provides information about swans, including tips to help you identify tundra swans and trumpeter swans in flight.

Important: The swan orientation course must be completed each year you apply for a tundra swan permit. Additionally, hunters who harvest a trumpeter swan will be unable to apply for a swan permit for several years. See the article on page 43 for details.

Reminder: You must also follow the mandatory harvest reporting rules listed on page 31, even if you do not harvest a tundra swan.

Apply for a crane, grouse or tundra swan permit



Beginning **June 30, 2026**, apply for a sandhill crane, greater sage-grouse, sharp-tailed grouse or tundra swan permit or preference point online at utahdraws.com or call the hunt drawing helpline at **855-883-7297 (855-UTDRAWS)**.

APPLICATION BEGINS

JUNE 30, 8 A.M. MDT

Application fees (per species):
Resident: \$10 • Nonresident: \$21

APPLICATION ENDS

JULY 14, 11 P.M. MDT

Deadline to withdraw or edit your application

DRAWING RESULTS AVAILABLE

JULY 23

PERMITS MAILED

EARLY AUGUST

What to know:

- You must have a valid hunting or combination license to apply. If needed, you can buy a license at the same time you apply.
- You must be a Utah resident at the time of application to apply as a resident (see page 79 for the definition).
- Edit your hunt choices per species at anytime during the application period by visiting utahdraws.com and clicking the *View/Edit/Withdraw* button.
- Credit or debit cards must be valid through August 2026 (the division is not responsible for any bank charges incurred for the use of credit/debit cards).
- For application help, call the hunt drawing helpline at 855-883-7297. You can also call any division office before 5 p.m. on July 14.
- View drawing results at utahdraws.com.

Applying as a group

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-21

Instead of applying as an individual hunter, you and your friends and family can apply as a group for each of the following hunts:

- Greater sage-grouse
- Sharp-tailed grouse
- Sandhill crane
- Tundra swan

Up to four hunters—including residents and nonresidents—can apply together for these permits. See wildlife.utah.gov/licenses/groups for details.

Important: If you're a youth and you want an opportunity to draw one of the permits reserved for youth, do not apply in a group with an adult. Up to four youth hunters can apply together in a youth-only group. This allows youth to hunt with siblings, friends and cousins. When you apply in a youth-only group for one of these hunts, all hunters must meet the age requirement for the application to be processed as a youth-only application.

Preference points

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-9

Preference points ensure that applicants who are unsuccessful—or those who choose to apply only for a preference point—will have a better chance of obtaining a permit for that species in the next year's hunt drawing.

Important: You must complete the swan orientation course each year before you apply for a tundra swan preference point or permit. The course is available online at wildlife.utah.gov/swancourse.

A preference point is awarded for each unsuccessful application (by species). An individual who does not want to hunt sandhill crane, tundra swan, greater sage-grouse or sharp-tailed grouse in the current year may apply for a preference point only by selecting the appropriate hunt choice code on the application and paying the application fee.

If you are eligible for a type of permit, you are eligible to apply for a preference point. You cannot, however, apply for both a permit and a preference point in the same season.

Youth crane, grouse and tundra swan permits

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-21 and R657-62-22

Fifteen percent of each year's sandhill crane, tundra swan, greater sage-grouse and sharp-tailed grouse are reserved for youth hunters. You are considered a youth if you will be 17 years old or younger on July 31, 2026.

You can submit an application as an individual hunter or as a member of a youth-only group. To see more about applying as part of a youth-only group, see page 20.

When you apply in a youth-only group for a hunt, all hunters must meet the age requirement for the application to be processed as a youth-only application. If you're successful in drawing permits, please remember that all hunters under the age of 16 must be accompanied in the field by a parent, legal guardian or responsible person 21 years of age or older. For details on this requirement, see page the top of this page.

See details about youth turkey-hunting opportunities on page 28.

Options for active, deployed military personnel

If you are an active, deployed member of the military you can purchase a bonus or preference point, even if you missed an application period while deployed. The division will also waive the required combination or hunting license fee when you make that point purchase.

To qualify for these exemptions, a military member must:

- Be a resident of Utah
- Be deployed for 90 days or longer outside of Utah on federal orders from military command

- Not have previously received a bonus or preference point for the species and hunt type in the same year
- Otherwise be eligible to receive a bonus or preference point
- Pay a \$10 application fee (plus 2.2% transaction fee) per point received
- Submit an application for the exemption to the division no later than Dec. 31 of the qualifying year of being deployed

For additional information and the application form, visit wildlife.utah.gov/military.

A preference point will not be issued if you are successful in drawing a permit.

Reminder: If you obtain a permit that remains available after the hunt drawing, you will lose any accrued preference points.

How your preference points work in the drawing

In the drawing, applications are sorted into groups by the number of preference points by permit type—a 4-preference-point group, a 3-preference-point group and so on—from highest to lowest. Within each group of preference points, the applications are then sorted from lowest to highest draw numbers. Permits are awarded in order, based on the hunt choice selected.

Preference points are averaged and rounded down when two or more applicants apply as a group. For example, if hunter A with three preference points and hunter B with zero preference points apply as a group, the preference points are averaged (1.5) and rounded down to one. This process will determine in which group of preference points your application will be considered. Hunters with one preference point will be considered only after all groups or individuals with two or more preference points and before all groups or individuals with zero preference points.

Surrendering your permit

If you need to surrender your permit—and your hunting season hasn't started—you should consider surrendering the permit as soon as possible. If you surrender early enough, you'll be able to keep your preference points.

Reminder: If you surrender a sandhill crane, tundra swan, greater sage-grouse or sharp-tailed grouse permit at least 30 days before the start of the season, you'll get all of your previously accrued preference points back, but you will not earn a point for the current year.

Important: If you surrender a permit **less than 30 days before the season opens**, you will **lose** all of your previously accrued preference points for that permit type, and you will not earn a point for the current year.

To learn more about surrendering a permit, visit wildlife.utah.gov/refunds.

Group surrender

Reminder: If you obtain a permit through a group application—and then you decide to surrender it—you will not have your preference points reinstated unless your **entire** group meets the following conditions:

- All group members must surrender their permits
- Permit surrenders must occur at least 30 days before the start of the season

Note: Even if you meet the above conditions, you will not earn a point for the current year.

Important: If some of your group members surrender their permits **less than 30 days** from the season opener, **all** group members will lose **all** of their preference points for that species.

Members of the group may not surrender their permits individually unless the surrender occurs because of:

- Activation in the military
- An injury or illness that will prevent the individual from hunting
- Death

Permit refunds

Utah Code § 23A-4-207 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-42

The division rarely issues refunds for permits, licenses or certificates of registration, but there are some exceptions. To see if you're eligible for a refund, visit wildlife.utah.gov/refunds.

Reminder: If you are eligible for a refund, you must submit all required forms and accompanying paperwork **within 30 days of the season ending** in order to qualify for a full refund.

Forfeited permits

Any original license, permit, tag or certificate of registration becomes invalid when surrendered or forfeited, or when a duplicate or exchanged one is issued.

Utah's Walk-in Access program

Utah Admin. Rule R657-56-13

The Walk-in Access Program provides hunters, anglers and trappers access to privately owned land, streams, rivers, ponds or reservoirs.

If you use Utah's Walk-in Access properties, remember to obtain your annual WIA authorization number.

The DWR issues authorization numbers to track the use of WIA properties throughout the year and to assess the program's value to the public.

To obtain your authorization number, visit wildlife.utah.gov/walkinaccess and select "Authorization numbers." Follow the instructions and obtain your number. You can also request a number by calling your local division office (see page 2).

Also, remember that WIA properties are private land and may have special restrictions on season dates, allowable activities, species and weapon types. Visit wildlife.utah.gov/walkinaccess for details.

Waterfowl Slam program

This year, the division will continue the Waterfowl Slam program in partnership with multiple conservation organizations. Hunters who join the program can earn different sizes and colors of bands for harvesting drakes of various species.

Funds raised through the Waterfowl Slam program go toward wetland enhancement, migratory bird research,

and conservation and habitat improvement projects.

We have many exciting ideas for future efforts. Please consider participating in Utah's Waterfowl Slam program so we can make these projects happen! To learn more about the slam, visit wildlife.utah.gov/slams/waterfowl.



Upland Game Slam program

The division's Upland Game Slam program partners with multiple conservation organizations. Hunters who join the program contribute directly to funding upland game habitat projects and earn prizes for harvesting various upland game species. Goals of the program include:

- Encourage hunters to improve their upland game identification skills
- Help hunters learn more about upland game habitats and behavior
- Raise money for upland game-specific projects
- Create friendly competition among hunters

To learn more about the program, visit wildlife.utah.gov/slams/upland.



How to obtain a turkey permit

After you meet Utah's hunter education and license requirements (see page 14), you can apply for or obtain a wild turkey permit. You must have a turkey permit before you can hunt turkeys in Utah. This section provides information about the different types of turkey permits, the permit application process, bonus points, applying with a group and important dates for turkey hunters.

Types of turkey permits

There are a variety of wild turkey permits available to hunters:

- Limited-entry permits (spring)
- General-season permits (spring)
- Conservation permits (spring)
- Cooperative Wildlife Management Unit (CWMU) permits (spring)
- Management harvest permits (fall)

Reminder: You may obtain one permit for the spring season.

Important: You must carry the turkey permit on your person while you're hunting. You cannot alter your permit or transfer it to another person.

Fall management harvest permits: An individual may obtain up to three fall management harvest permits, which may include up to two beardless permits and one either-sex permit per hunter. These hunts are almost entirely on private land, and you are strongly encouraged to obtain documented permission from the landowner to hunt on any private property before you purchase this type of permit.

License requirements

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-22

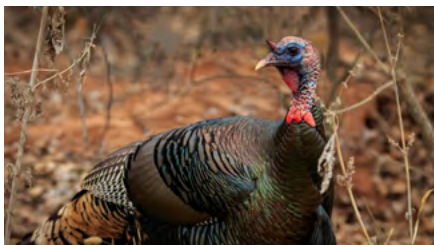
You must have a valid Utah hunting or combination license before you can apply for or obtain any of the permits listed above. You must also have a valid hunting or combination license in order to hunt wild turkey. If your hunting license expires before the hunting season ends, you'll have to buy a new license to hunt the remainder of the season.

Reminder: There are restrictions on fishing and hunting license purchasers for nonpayment of child support. For additional information—or to arrange a payment schedule—please contact the Office of Recovery Services at 801-536-8500.

Obtaining over the counter permits

Over-the-counter permits are available wildlife.utah.gov, license agents and DWR offices. Management harvest permits (fall) are available beginning Sept. 10, 2026 at 8 a.m. MDT and general-season permits (spring) are available beginning March 11, 2027 at 8 a.m. MDT. You must have a valid hunting or combination license before purchasing one of these types of permits.

Apply for a spring limited-entry turkey permit



Beginning **Dec. 15, 2026**, apply for a limited-entry turkey permit, a CWMU permit or a bonus point online at utahdraws.com or call the hunt drawing helpline at **855-883-7297 (855-UTDRAWS)**.

APPLICATION BEGINS

DEC. 15, AT 8 A.M. MDT

Application fee:

Resident: \$10 • Nonresident: \$21



APPLICATION ENDS

DEC. 29, AT 11 P.M. MDT

Deadline to withdraw or edit your application



DRAWING RESULTS AVAILABLE

JAN. 7, 2027



REMAINING LIMITED-ENTRY AND SPRING GENERAL-SEASON PERMITS AVAILABLE

MARCH 11, 2027

What to know:

- You must have a valid hunting or combination license to apply. If needed, you can buy a license at the same time you apply.
- You must be a Utah resident at the time of application to apply as a resident (see page 79 for the definition).
- Edit your application at no charge anytime during the application period by visiting utahdraws.com and clicking the *View/Edit/Withdraw* button.
- Credit or debit cards must be valid through February 2027 (the division is not responsible for any bank charges incurred for the use of credit/debit cards).
- For application help, call the hunt drawing helpline at 855-883-7297. You can also call any division office before 5 p.m. on Dec. 29.
- View drawing results at utahdraws.com.

Applying as a group

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-25

Instead of applying as an individual hunter, you and your friends and family can apply as a group for limited-entry turkey permits.

Up to four hunters—including both residents and nonresidents—can apply together by using a group code. See wildlife.utah.gov/licenses/groups for details. If your group is successful in the drawing, all of the applicants in your group who have valid applications will receive a permit.

Important: If you're a youth and you want an opportunity to draw one of the wild turkey permits reserved for youth, do **not** apply in a group with an adult. Up to **four youth hunters** can apply to hunt together in a **youth-only group**. This allows youth to hunt wild turkeys with siblings, friends and cousins.

When you apply in a youth-only group for this hunt, all hunters must meet the age requirement for the application to be processed as a youth-only application.

Waiting periods

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-25

Waiting periods do not apply to turkey limited-entry permits.

Bonus points

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-8

A turkey bonus point system was started in 2000 to increase your chance of drawing a limited-entry turkey permit.

Here's a quick look at how your bonus points work in the drawing:

- Fifty percent of the permits (rounded up) for each limited-entry hunting unit are reserved for applicants who have the greatest number of bonus points.
- You receive a random drawing number for your current turkey application and a random drawing number for every turkey bonus point you have. Your lowest random number is then used in the drawing. (The lower your number, the better your chance at drawing a permit.)

How bonus points are earned:

- You receive a bonus point each time you're unsuccessful in drawing a limited-entry turkey permit.
- If you don't plan to hunt a turkey during the upcoming limited-entry season, you may apply for a bonus point only. Simply select the appropriate hunt choice code (TKY) on the application and pay the application fee.
- You may apply for either a limited-entry turkey permit or a bonus point, but not both.

You cannot apply for or receive a bonus point if your hunting privileges are suspended for turkey or small game.

Once you draw a limited-entry or CWMU permit—or obtain a remaining limited-entry permit—you lose any bonus points you've accumulated. You'll start earning bonus points again the next time you apply for a limited-entry or CWMU turkey permit and are unsuccessful in that year's drawing.

Note: You will not lose your bonus points if you purchase a turkey general-season permit.

Surrendering your permit

If you need to surrender your limited-entry wild turkey permit—and your hunting season hasn't started—you should consider surrendering the permit as soon as possible. If you surrender early enough, you'll be able to keep your bonus points.

Reminder: If you surrender a limited-entry turkey permit at least 30 days before the start of the season, you'll get all of your previously accrued bonus points back, but you will not earn a point for the current year.

Important: If you surrender your permit **less than 30 days before the season opens**, you will **lose** all of your previously accrued bonus points, and you will not earn a point for the current year.

To learn more about surrendering a permit, visit wildlife.utah.gov/refunds.

Group surrender

Reminder: If you obtain a limited-entry wild turkey permit through a group application—and then you decide to surrender it—you will not have your bonus points reinstated unless your **entire** group meets the following conditions:

- All group members must surrender their permits
- Permit surrenders must occur at least 30 days before the start of the season

Note: Even if you meet the above conditions, you will not earn a point for the current year.

Important: If some of your group members surrender their permits **less than 30 days** from the season opener, **all** group members will lose **all** of their bonus points for that species.

Members of the group may not surrender their permits individually unless the surrender occurs because of:

- Activation in the military
- An injury or illness that will prevent the individual from hunting
- Death

Permit refunds

Utah Code § 23A-4-207 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-42

The division rarely issues refunds for licenses or permits, but there are some exceptions. To see if you're eligible for a refund, visit wildlife.utah.gov/refunds.

Reminder: If you are eligible for a refund, you must submit all required forms and accompanying paperwork **within 30 days** of the season ending in order to qualify for a full refund.

Forfeited permits

Any original license, permit, tag or certificate of registration becomes invalid when surrendered or forfeited, or when a duplicate or exchanged one is issued.

General-season permits

Utah Admin. Rule R657-54a-20

Utah will hold management harvest hunts in the fall of 2026. These hunts will be in addition to the spring general-season hunt of 2026. Here's what you need to know about obtaining permits for the general-season hunts.

Fall 2026 management harvest hunts

The fall turkey hunt was established to decrease turkey nuisance and depredation issues that result in damage to private property.

A hunter may purchase up to for three fall management harvest turkey permits (two beardless permits and one either-sex permit per hunter).

There will be a limited number of permits for four management harvest turkey hunts in the following areas Oct. 1, 2026–Feb. 28, 2027:

- Central Region
- Northern Region
- Southeastern Region
- Southern Region

Important: Only specified areas within each of these regions will be open to hunting during the fall. A permit allows you to hunt all of the specified areas within a region.

Before you purchase this permit, be aware that these hunt areas are almost entirely on private property. We highly recommend that you obtain documented permission from

the landowner to hunt on any private property before you purchase a permit. To see hunt boundary maps, visit hunt.utah.gov in August 2026.

Permits for the fall 2026 management harvest turkey hunts will be available beginning Sept. 10, 2026. Visit wildlife.utah.gov/uplandgame in August to see purchase times and locations.

Fifteen percent of Utah's fall management harvest turkey permits are reserved for youth (those who are 17 years old and younger by July 31, 2026). For more information on opportunities for youth, see the information box below.

Keep in mind: The fall turkey hunt is designed to reduce turkey populations and address conflicts between turkeys and landowners. Permit numbers are set solely with this goal in mind. For this reason, female (beardless) harvest is encouraged. You may obtain up to three fall management harvest turkey permits (two beardless permits and one either-sex permit per hunter). You do not need to harvest a bearded turkey.

Turkey hunting opportunities for youth

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-25 and R657-54a-20

If you're a youth hunter, make sure you understand all of the opportunities you have to hunt and harvest a wild turkey.

You may obtain one permit for the spring season (limited-entry or general-season) and three permits for the fall season.

Limited-entry permits for youth

Fifteen percent of Utah's turkey limited-entry permits have been set aside for young hunters.

If you'll be 17 years old or younger on July 31, 2027, you'll be eligible for the youth permit drawing when you apply for your permit.

You can submit an application as an individual hunter or as a member of a youth-only group. For more information on applying as part of a youth-only group, see *Applying as a group* on page 25.

With a turkey limited-entry permit, you can hunt only the unit listed on your permit from April 10–29, 2027. And, if you don't harvest a turkey during the limited-entry season, you may participate in the spring general-season youth hunt and the spring general season. Once the general-

season hunts begin, you may hunt in the statewide general-season area.

General-season permits and the youth-only hunt

If you're a youth who obtains a turkey general-season permit, you can participate in Utah's Youth Turkey Hunt from April 30–May 2, 2027. (See page 74 for shooting hours.) This hunt will be restricted to youth who are 17 years old or younger on July 31, 2027.

If you do not harvest a turkey during the youth hunt, you can continue to hunt during the turkey general season, which runs from May 3–31, 2027.

Fifteen percent of the fall management harvest permits will also be set aside for youth. For more information about fall turkey permits, see the section beginning on page 27.

Youth under the age of 16 must be accompanied by an adult in the field. Please see page 14 for more information about this requirement.

For information on youth upland game hunts, please see page 12.

Spring 2027 general-season hunt

Spring general-season permits will be available beginning at 8 a.m. on March 11, 2027 at wildlife.utah.gov and from license agents and division offices.

You may obtain a spring general-season turkey permit if you meet the basic hunting requirements (see page 14), and you didn't obtain a limited-entry turkey permit for the spring 2027 season.

Young hunters who obtain general-season turkey permits will have the opportunity to participate in the youth hunt. For details, see the information box on page 28.

Additional turkey permits

In addition to limited-entry and general-season permits, other types of turkey permits are available.

Conservation permits

Utah Admin. Rule R657-41

You may obtain conservation permits in addition to any other turkey permit you've obtained.

Turkey conservation permits are available from nonprofit conservation organizations. The organizations usually sell the permits at fundraising banquets. A list of organizations selling conservation permits for Utah's 2027 turkey season will be available at wildlife.utah.gov/conservationpermits by late December 2026.

Cooperative Wildlife Management Unit permits

Utah Admin. Rule R657-37

You can enjoy hunting turkeys on private property in Utah through the state's Cooperative Wildlife Management Unit (CWMU) program. Here's how the CWMU program works:

Private lands can become CWMUs if the landowners work with the division to manage the land for turkeys. Private landowners who own land that qualifies as a CWMU are given permits they can sell to hunters. In return, the landowners agree to allow an equal number of public hunters—those who obtain CWMU permits through the state's drawing—onto their CWMUs to hunt.

You can obtain a CWMU permit in one of two ways: you can either apply for one in the turkey drawing, or you can contact a CWMU operator directly to inquire about purchasing a permit. For a list of CWMU operators, visit wildlife.utah.gov/CWMU.

For more information about obtaining a CWMU permit, contact the nearest division office.

Public land in CWMUs: Public land use is restricted **only** for those species the CWMU is enrolled in each season (such as elk or turkey). If you are hunting upland game, you **may** hunt upland game on **public lands** in CWMU properties; all season dates and bag limits apply.

Prepare for your crane, tundra swan, grouse or turkey hunt

Utah Admin. Rule R657-62-22, R657-9-5, R657-9-7 and R657-54-11, and Utah Code § 23A-4-709

If you obtain a sandhill crane, tundra swan, wild turkey, greater sage-grouse or sharp-tailed grouse permit, be prepared to meet these requirements.

Tag your bird

Utah Code § 23A-4-709 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-5 and R657-54-11

Sandhill crane, turkey, greater sage-grouse and sharp-tailed grouse: You must tag the carcass immediately upon taking possession of the bird.

Tundra swan: You may wait to tag the tundra swan until after you return to your blind, your boat (or other vessel) or dry land, whichever is nearest to the point where the bird was retrieved.

See the *Tagging requirements* section (page 46) in the general Field Regulations section of this guidebook for tagging instructions.

Reminder: You may not hunt or pursue a crane, turkey, swan or grouse after any of the following has occurred:

- Shooting and retrieving the bird
- Detaching the tag from the permit
- Removing any of the notches from the tag

New: Tundra swan and turkey hunters can now submit an e-tag through the Utah Hunting and Fishing app. It's the same as notching a paper tag, and fulfills mandatory harvest reporting requirements upon completion. Turkey hunters should review e-tagging instructions on page 46 before going into the field. Additional measurement requirements apply for swan hunters (see page 32). Learn more about this convenient new option at wildlife.utah.gov/e-tag.

Check in your swan within 72 hours

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-7

Important: Within 72 hours of taking a tundra or trumpeter swan, you are required to check in the entire swan or its head at a DWR office (see page 2 for locations and office hours) or the Bear River Migratory Bird Refuge office (Fridays and Saturdays only, 9 a.m.–noon and 2–7 p.m.).

Remember: Prior to or at the time you check in your swan, you must complete your harvest survey in order to finish the swan check-in process. You can submit a harvest survey online at wildlife.utah.gov/harvest, or call any DWR office (page 2) for assistance.

New: If you choose to electronically tag your swan (see the information box on page 32 for instructions), submitting your e-tag in the Utah Hunting and Fishing app fulfills both the swan check in and mandatory reporting requirements.

Complete the mandatory harvest report

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-7 and R657-54a)

If you obtain a tundra swan or **(new)** wild turkey permit, be sure to meet the harvest reporting requirements in a timely manner.

Tundra swan harvest reporting

If you obtain a tundra swan permit and harvest a swan, you must complete the mandatory harvest survey prior to or during your swan check in, or by completing an e-tagging submission through the Utah Hunting and Fishing app.

Important: If you did not hunt or take a swan you still need to complete the mandatory harvest report by Jan. 12, 2027. You can complete the harvest survey online at wildlife.utah.gov/harvest, or call any division office for assistance.

Swan check-in: If you harvest any swan, you are required to check in the entire swan or its head within 72 hours at a DWR office (see page 2) or the Bear River Migratory Bird Refuge office (Fridays and Saturdays only, 9 a.m.–noon and 2–7 p.m.).

New e-tag option: See the information box on page 32 for instructions.

Turkey harvest reporting (new)

New: The Utah Wildlife Board approved mandatory harvest reporting for wild turkey (for both spring and fall seasons) beginning with the fall 2026 season. This data will help evaluate turkey population trends, gauge harvest success and collect other valuable information.

If you obtain a turkey permit of any kind, you must complete a harvest report **within 30 days of the end of your hunt season**—even if you did not harvest a bird.

What if I miss the deadline?

(New) Turkey permit holders: If you miss the reporting deadline following the turkey hunt season, you will be ineligible to apply for a turkey permit in the December 2027 limited-entry application unless you:

- Complete and submit a late harvest survey
- Pay a \$25 late fee

Tundra swan permit holders: If you miss the Jan. 12, 2027 reporting deadline, you will be ineligible to apply for a swan permit in 2027 unless you:

- Get the head of your harvested swan examined at a DWR office
- Complete and submit a late harvest survey
- Pay a \$25 late fee

Remember: If you did not harvest a tundra swan, you would only be required to complete the last two items before applying for a 2027 tundra swan permit. Harvest reporting requirements apply even if you did not hunt or take a swan.

E-tag option for tundra swan reporting

Electronic tagging is an optional check-in method and allows hunters to submit an e-tag and measurements through the Utah Hunting and Fishing app.

When applying for a tundra swan permit, hunters may select either the standard in-person check-in or e-tagging option.

Hunters who enroll in e-tagging must carry a bill-measuring card while hunting (the DWR will mail you the card if you obtain a permit). After harvesting a tundra swan, you must complete the electronic tagging process immediately upon returning to your blind, boat (or other vessel), or the first area of dry land nearest the point of retrieval.

Using the Utah Hunting and Fishing app, you must:

- Submit your electronic tag
- Enter all required harvest information
- Record bill measurements using the bill-measuring card
- Upload all required photographs

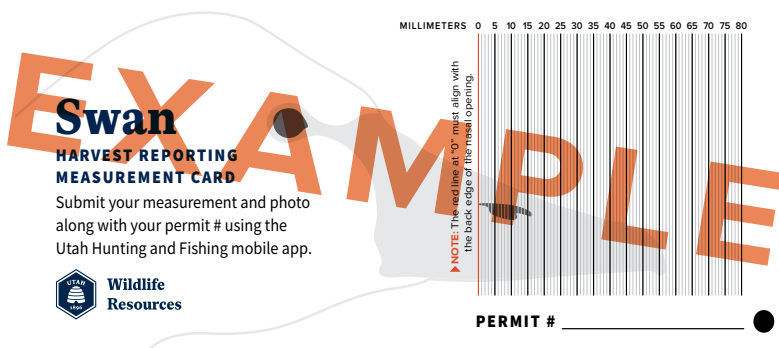
A valid electronic submission satisfies the tagging requirement. Hunters using e-tagging are not required to use a paper carcass tag or complete an in-person head measurement.

Additionally, by submitting an e-tag, you will fulfill your mandatory harvest survey requirement.

Remember: If you do not hunt or harvest a swan, do not submit an e-tag; complete your mandatory harvest survey within 30 days of the close of the swan season at wildlife.utah.gov/harvest.

Important: If you believe you may have harvested a trumpeter swan, complete the e-tagging process immediately, then contact any DWR office (page 2) or the UTiP hotline at 800-662-3337, and bring the entire swan to a DWR office for identification and inspection. Do not process the bird.

Watch a short video with instructions on how to e-tag your tundra swan at wildlife.utah.gov/e-tag.



Field regulations

While hunting migratory game birds, upland game or turkey in Utah, you should know the requirements for carrying and using firearms, crossbows and archery tackle. You should also know the different hunting methods you may use and what you're required to do with any game you take.

Firearms, crossbows and archery tackle

50 CFR 20.21, Utah Code § 23A-5-309 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-6, R657-6-7 and R657-54a-4

Several rules apply to the types of firearms, crossbows, archery tackle and ammunition that you may use to take small game in Utah. Requirements vary depending on if you are hunting waterfowl and other migratory game birds, upland game or turkey.

Waterfowl and other migratory game birds

You may take migratory game birds with any of the following:

- A shotgun no larger than 10 gauge
- A crossbow
- Archery equipment, including a draw lock

During most Utah migratory game bird hunts, the shotgun you use cannot be capable of holding more than three shells (one in the chamber and two in the magazine).

Many shotguns can hold more than two shells in the magazine, but making these guns legal for migratory game bird hunting is easy. An inexpensive item, called a "shotgun plug," comes with most shotguns or you can purchase one at most sporting goods stores.

And don't forget: You may use an unplugged shotgun—capable of holding more than three shells—to hunt light geese during the February–March season. For season dates, see page 65.

Important: Sandhill crane may be taken only with nontoxic shot, but there's no restriction on the size of the nontoxic shot you may use (to learn more about nontoxic shot, please see the next section in this guidebook).

In addition to the requirements above, you may **not** use any of the following:

- A handgun
- A firearm capable of being fired fully automatic
- Any light-enhancement device or aiming device that casts a visible beam of light
- Aircraft, drone or other airborne vehicle or device

Participate in DWR surveys

After your migratory game bird or upland game hunting season ends, the DWR may email you to request your participation in an online survey.

Although the DWR surveys are not mandatory, we encourage you to complete them, even if you didn't harvest. These voluntary surveys help the division evaluate population trends, gauge harvest success and collect other valuable information.

Important: This request will be different from and in addition to your annual HIP survey. There are also mandatory reporting requirements for tundra swan and turkey (see page 31).

Nontoxic shot and use of firearms, crossbows and archery tackle

50 CFR 20.21(j) and Utah Admin. Rules R657-9-8 and R657-9-9

A shotgun loaded with nontoxic shot is the only firearm you may discharge while hunting sandhill crane, waterfowl or coot in any area of the state. (To learn what nontoxic shot is, please see page 78 of this guide.)

In addition, nontoxic shot is the only ammunition you may have in your possession while on:

- All federal refuges
- Box Elder County—Harold S. Crane, Locomotive Springs, Public Shooting Grounds, Salt Creek and Willard Spur WMAs
- Daggett County—Brown's Park WMA
- Davis County—Farmington Bay, Howard Slough and Ogden Bay WMAs
- Emery County—Desert Lake WMA
- Grand County—Scott and Norma Matheson Wetlands Preserve
- Juab County—Mills Meadows WMA
- Millard County—Clear Lake and Topaz Slough WMAs
- Sanpete County—Manti Meadows WMA
- Tooele County—Blue Lake and Timpie Springs WMAs
- Salt Lake County—Blackhawk WMA
- Uintah County—Stewart Lake WMA
- Utah County—Powell Slough and Provo River Delta WMAs and the Utah Lake Wetland Preserve
- Wayne County—Bicknell Bottoms WMA
- Weber County—Ogden Bay and Harold S. Crane WMAs

You may not discharge a firearm, crossbow or archery tackle on any of the areas listed above at any time of the year, except during the open migratory game bird hunting seasons or as authorized by the division.

Upland game

You may hunt and harvest upland game with any of the following:

- Archery equipment, including a draw lock
- A crossbow
- A shotgun no larger than 10 gauge
- A handgun
- An air rifle (**for cottontail rabbits and snowshoe hares only**)

Ammunition for shotguns and handguns must be one-half ounce or more of shot that ranges in size from no. 2 through no. 8.

Also called a pre-charged pneumatic air rifle, an air rifle must:

- Fire using compressed air released from a chamber built into the rifle.
- Be pressurized at a minimum of 2,000 per square inch from an external high-compression device (such as a hand pump, compressor or scuba tank).
- Fire a single broadhead tipped bolt or arrow.

And must fire a pellet or slug that:

- Is .25 caliber or larger.
- Weighs 18 grains or more.
- Is fired at a velocity to produce at least 30 foot-pounds of energy at the muzzle.

The only exceptions to these rules are as follows:

- Cottontail rabbit and snowshoe hare may be taken with any firearm that is not capable of being fired fully automatic.

Additionally, you may **not** use any of the following:

- A firearm capable of being fired fully automatic
- Any light-enhancement device or aiming device that casts a visible beam of light
- Aircraft, drone or other airborne vehicle or device

Wild turkey

You may hunt and harvest a turkey with any of the following:

- Archery equipment, including a draw lock, using broadhead-tipped arrows.
- A crossbow, using broadhead-tipped arrows or bolts.
- Any shotgun firing shot BB or smaller diameter.
- Rimfire firearms **(during the fall turkey season only)**.
- Air rifles **(during the fall turkey season only)**.

Also called a pre-charged pneumatic air rifle, an air rifle must:

- Fire using compressed air released from a chamber built into the rifle.
- Be pressurized at a minimum of 2,000 per square inch from an external high-compression device (such as a hand pump, compressor or scuba tank).
- Fire a single broadhead tipped bolt or arrow.

And must fire a pellet or slug that:

- Is .25 caliber or larger.
- Weighs 18 grains or more.
- Is fired at a velocity to produce at least 30 foot-pounds of energy at the muzzle.

Are you allowed to possess a weapon?

Utah Code §§ 76-11-302 and 76-11-303

It is illegal under *Utah Code §§ 76-11-302 and 76-11-303* to possess or use a firearm, muzzleloader or any other dangerous weapon if you have been charged or convicted of certain offenses.

The purchase or possession of any hunting license, permit, tag or certificate of registration from the division does not authorize the holder to legally possess or use a firearm, muzzleloader or any other dangerous weapon while hunting if they are otherwise restricted from possessing these weapons under Utah Code.

To determine whether you are allowed to possess a weapon, review the Utah Code sections listed above or contact the law enforcement agency that oversees your case.

Loaded firearms in a vehicle

Utah Code §§ 76-11-102, 53-5a-3, 76-11-204 and 53-5a-108

You may not carry a loaded firearm in or on a vehicle unless you meet all of the following conditions:

- You own the vehicle or have permission from the vehicle's owner.
- The firearm is a handgun.
- You are 18 years of age or older.

A pistol, revolver, rifle or shotgun is considered to be loaded when there is an unexpended cartridge, shell or projectile in the firing position.

Pistols and revolvers are also considered to be loaded when an unexpended cartridge, shell or projectile is in a position whereby the manual operation of any mechanism once would cause the unexpended cartridge, shell or projectile to be fired.

A muzzleloading firearm is considered loaded when it is capped or primed and has a powder charge and ball or shot in the barrel or cylinder(s).

Areas where you can't discharge a firearm

Utah Code § 76-11-208

You may not discharge a dangerous weapon or firearm under any of these circumstances:

- From a vehicle
- From, upon or across any highway
- At power lines or signs
- At railroad equipment or facilities, including any sign or signal
- Within Utah state park camp or picnic sites, overlooks, boat ramps or developed beaches
- Without written permission from the owner or property manager, within 600 feet of:
 - A house, dwelling or any other building
 - Any structure in which a domestic animal is kept or fed, including a barn, poultry yard, corral, feeding pen or stockyard

Hunter orange requirements

Although there are no regulations that govern what you should wear on a migratory game bird, upland game or turkey hunt, your choice of clothing for some types of hunts could affect your safety.

For Utah's upland game hunts, we strongly encourage you to wear hunter orange in the field. It will make you more visible to other hunters at a time of year when there are many different hunts in progress.

For Utah's turkey hunts, we discourage you from wearing hunter orange. Hunters sometimes mistake bright colors for the head of a turkey.

Areas with special restrictions

Although many areas are open to hunters, some are closed or have specific restrictions.

State parks

Utah Code § 76-11-208 and Utah Admin. Rule R651-614-4

Hunting of wildlife is allowed within the boundaries of all state park areas, **except** those areas and hunts specifically closed by the Utah Division of State Parks in *Utah Admin. Rule R651-614-4*. For more information, visit stateparks.utah.gov/resources/hunting-at-state-parks.

State laws regarding the possession and discharge of dangerous weapons apply in state park areas open to hunting. For information about discharging a dangerous weapon or firearm in a state park, see page 36 or review *Utah Code § 76-11-208*.

In addition to the rules above, the Great Salt Lake Marina and posted areas adjacent to the marina are closed to hunting.

Waterfowl hunting, including the retrieval of downed birds, is also prohibited on all of Antelope Island, including all areas within 600 feet of the upland vegetative line or any other clearly defined high water mark. Hunting is also prohibited within 600 feet of the north or south side of the Antelope Island causeway.

Hunting with shotguns, crossbows or archery tackle is prohibited within 1/4 mile of open state park areas, unless otherwise authorized by the state park.

Areas closed to upland game hunting

Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-21

You may not hunt in any area posted closed by the division or in any of the following areas:

- Salt Lake International Airport is closed to hunting within posted airport boundaries.
- Many Utah towns, cities and incorporated municipalities have laws that restrict hunting and the discharge of firearms within city limits. Contact the city's administrative office for specific laws and boundaries.
- All national wildlife refuges in Utah are closed to crow hunting and to most other hunting, unless they have been declared open by the managing authority. For example, Fish Springs National Wildlife Refuge is **only open to chukar partridge and cottontail rabbit hunters**. See page 57 for details.
- The Goshen Warm Springs WMA is closed to all hunting.
- Some WMAs are closed to the general public each year for sponsored, organized youth and beginner pheasant hunts. This year those areas are the Gordon Creek WMA (upper fields) on Oct. 31; and the Annabella, Pahvant and Pine Canyon WMAs, and a portion of the Ogden Bay WMA on Nov. 14. For details visit wildlife.utah.gov/uplandgame/youth.
- Military installations, including Camp Williams, are closed to hunting and trespassing.

Some waterfowl management areas are open, but they have weapon, ammunition and season restrictions. For detailed information, see page 62.

Areas closed to turkey hunting

Utah Admin. Rule R657-54a-14

You may not hunt wild turkeys in any area posted closed by the DWR or in any of the following areas:

- Salt Lake International Airport boundaries as posted.
- Many Utah towns, cities and incorporated municipalities have laws that restrict hunting and the discharge of firearms within city limits. Contact the city's administrative office for specific laws and boundaries.
- All state waterfowl management areas, except Brown's Park and Stewart Lake.
- All national wildlife refuges, unless they have been declared open by the managing authority. For example, Ouray National Wildlife Refuge is **only open to youth turkey hunters** during the 2026 turkey season.
- Military installations, including Camp Williams, are closed to hunting and trespassing.

Areas with motorized vehicle restrictions

Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-14

Motorized vehicle travel on all state wildlife management areas is restricted to county roads and improved roads that are posted open to vehicles.

Trespassing

Utah Code §§ 23A-5-317 and 23A-5-310

While taking wildlife or engaging in wildlife-related activities, you may not—without documented permission—enter or remain on privately owned land that is:

- Cultivated
- Properly posted
- Fenced or enclosed in a manner designed to exclude intruders

In addition, you may not:

- Enter or remain on private land when directed not to do so by the owner or a person acting for the owner.
- Obstruct any entrance or exit to private property.

“Cultivated land” is land that is readily identifiable as land whose soil is loosened or broken up for the raising of crops, land used for the raising of crops, or a pasture that is artificially irrigated.

“Permission” means documented authorization from the owner or person in charge to enter upon private land that is cultivated or properly posted. Permission must include all of the following details:

- The signature of the owner or person in charge
- The name of the person being given permission
- The appropriate dates
- A general description of the land

“Properly posted” means that signs prohibiting trespass—or bright yellow, bright orange or fluorescent paint—are clearly displayed at all corners, on fishing streams crossing property lines, and on roads, gates and rights-of-way entering the land. Or, they are displayed in a manner that is visible to a person in the area.

You may not post private property you do not own or legally control or land that is open to the public as provided by *Utah Code § 23A-6-402*. In addition, it is unlawful to take protected wildlife or its parts while trespassing in violation of *Utah Code § 23A-5-317*.

You are guilty of a class B misdemeanor if you violate any provision described in this section. Your license, tag or permit privileges may also be suspended.

Farmington Bay WMA buffer zones

Hunters should be aware that there are 150-foot no hunting/no trespassing buffer zones on several portions of Farmington Bay Waterfowl Management Area. Please check the Hunt Planner (hunt.utah.gov) for details before going into the field, and heed all signage in the area while hunting.

No-shooting areas

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-32

The division has designated certain portions of the state as no-shooting areas. In these areas, the discharge of weapons for the purpose of hunting is prohibited. No-shooting areas remain open to the public for other lawful activities. The following locations are designated as no-shooting areas:

- All of Antelope Island—This includes all areas within 600 feet of the upland vegetative line or other clearly defined high water mark
- Antelope Island causeway—Within 600 feet of the north and south sides of the center line of the causeway
- Brown's Park WMA—within 300 feet **(new)** of all structures
- Farmington Bay WMA—within 600 feet of the headquarters, within 600 feet of dikes and roads accessible by motorized vehicles, within the area designated as the Hase-nyager Nature Preserve and within the 300-foot retrieval zone around the rest area
- Gunnison Bend Reservoir—below the high-water mark of the reservoir and its inflow, upstream to the Southerland Bridge (Millard County)
- Ogden Bay WMA—within 300 feet **(new)** of the headquarters area
- Provo River Delta WMA—within 600 feet of Lakeview Parkway, Boat Harbor Drive, the Provo River Delta parking lot and the Provo River Delta Trail
- Salt Creek WMA—within the 200-foot retrieval zone extending east from the southeast corner of Rest Lake, and north to the intersection with Salt Creek bypass canal and the northeast corner of Rest Lake
- Within the boundaries of all Utah State Parks, except those designated open by appropriate signage (see *Utah Administrative Rule R651-614-4*)
- Within 1/3 of a mile of the Great Salt Lake Marina
- All property within the boundary of the Salt Lake International Airport
- All property within the boundaries of federal migratory bird refuges, unless hunting waterfowl is specifically authorized by the federal government

Rest areas

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-32

Unless you have prior permission from the DWR, you may access and use state waterfowl or wildlife management areas (WMAs) only during the hunting season or for other activities for which the WMAs have been posted open. While you're on a WMA, you may not participate in activities that are prohibited on the WMA.

In addition to the rules above, the DWR has established portions of the WMAs as rest areas for wildlife. These areas are closed to the public, and trespass of any kind is prohibited. The following locations are designated as rest areas:

- Clear Lake WMA—the area known as Spring Lake
- Desert Lake WMA—the area known as Desert Lake
- Farmington Bay WMA—the area that lies in the northwest quarter of Unit 1
- Ogden Bay WMA—the area known as North Bachman and extending north to the Unit One Dike Road and east to the spillways of South Run Road
- Public Shooting Grounds WMA—the area that lies above and adjacent to the Hull Lake Diversion Dike, known as Duck Lake

Commercial hunting areas

In addition to hunting Utah's wild upland game birds, you can also hunt pheasant, partridge and quail on commercial hunting areas (CHAs).

The CHA season runs from Aug. 31 to March 31. CHAs typically charge on a per-bird basis. Hunter education or trial-hunting authorization is required, but you do not need a hunting license to hunt on a CHA.

See wildlife.utah.gov/uplandgame for more information.

No drones allowed

Utah Code § 23A-5-309 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-5-14

The use of any type of aircraft, drone or other airborne vehicle or device to locate, or attempt to observe or locate any protected wildlife is prohibited. This includes scouting and hunting.

- Salt Creek WMA—the area known as Rest Lake

Obtain maps of the rest areas by visiting DWR offices or wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl.

Checkpoints and officer contacts

Utah Code §§ 23A-5-207 and 77-23-104

To help the division fulfill its responsibility as trustee and guardian of Utah's wildlife, state conservation officers monitor the taking and possession of wildlife, and the required licenses, permits, firearms and equipment used for hunting. You should expect to encounter conservation officers and biologists in the field and at checkpoints.

Hunters with disabilities

Utah Admin. Rule R657-12

Utah provides special hunting accommodations for people with disabilities. Among those accommodations are special-use blinds for disabled or wheelchair-bound hunters.

For a complete copy of these accommodations and what's required to qualify for them, please visit wildlife.utah.gov/accessibility or call any division office.

Commercial guiding and outfitting

Utah Code § 23A-4-1201 and 23A-12-302, and Utah Admin. Rule R657-72 and R6567-28-8

Guides and outfitters are required to have a special use permit before guiding or transporting hunters across waterfowl and wildlife management areas. This change applies to anyone who receives more than \$100 in compensation for providing guiding services, as defined in *Utah Code 58-79-102*.

Important: Details about requirements and how to obtain a permit are available at wildlife.utah.gov/guides. Remember, SUP applications are due by the end of August to be valid for this season's hunts.

Remember: Guides and outfitters in Utah are regulated by the DWR (not the Department of Professional Licensing) as approved by the Utah Legislature. If you are a guide or outfitter, visit wildlife.utah.gov/licenses/guides for important information about the licensing application, registration fees and other operational requirements.

Technology restrictions

No drones allowed

Utah Code § 23A-5-309 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-5-14

The use of any type of aircraft, drone or other airborne vehicle or device to locate, or attempt to observe or locate, any protected wildlife is prohibited. This includes scouting and hunting of protected wildlife.

Trail cameras and night-vision devices

Utah Admin. Rule R657-5-7 and Utah Code § 23A-5-307

Since 2022, there have been several Utah Wildlife Board and legislative updates regarding the use of trail cameras and night-vision devices. Some of these rules may affect migratory game bird and upland game hunters.

All trail cameras are prohibited on public land from July 31 to Dec. 31 (with exceptions for approved research and monitoring).

- A trail camera using internal data storage—and not capable of transmitting live data—is permitted for use on private land for the purposes of legal hunting.
- It is unlawful to possess any type of night-vision device while locating, taking or attempting to locate protected wildlife from July 31 to Dec. 31.

Visit wildlife.utah.gov/trailcams for more information about these rules.

Hunting methods

Several rules apply to the methods you can use to hunt upland waterfowl and other migratory game birds, upland game and wild turkeys in Utah.

Baiting

50 CFR 20.11 and 20.21, Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-13 and R657-54-9, Utah Code § 23A-5-309

Baiting is an illegal activity that involves the spreading of shelled, shucked or unshucked grain, feed or salt to lure, attract or entice birds to an area for the purposes of hunting them. You may **not** hunt upland game, wild turkey or migratory game birds by baiting, and you may **not** hunt in an area where you reasonably should have known that the area is or has been baited.

An area is considered to be baited for 10 days after the bait has been completely removed from the area.

You can take upland game, wild turkey or migratory game birds on or over any of the following lands or areas, so long as these areas have not been baited:

- Standing crops or flooded standing crops (including aquatics)
- Standing, flooded or manipulated natural vegetation
- Flooded harvested croplands
- Lands or areas where seeds or grains have been scattered solely as the result of a normal agricultural planting, harvesting, post-harvest manipulation or normal soil-stabilization practice
- From a blind or other place of concealment camouflaged with vegetation from agricultural crops, as long as such camouflaging does not result in the exposing, depositing, distributing or scattering of grain or other feed
- Standing or flooded standing agricultural crops where grain is inadvertently scattered solely as a result of a hunter entering or exiting a hunting area, placing decoys or retrieving downed birds

For example, a farmer working his land after harvesting a crop does not render his field “baited” — so long as the post-harvest manipulation of the farmer’s field is a normal agricultural process. To see detailed information about normal agricultural processes, visit bit.ly/title50. For the hunter, the presence of rows, piles or other concentrations of grain should raise questions about the legality of the area for upland game or wild turkey hunting.

In addition to the provisions above, you cannot take sandhill crane on or over lands where standing crops have been manipulated to distribute or scatter grain or other feed on the land where it was grown. You can take other upland game species and wild turkey on or over lands where standing crops have been manipulated to distribute or scatter grain or other feed on the land where it was grown, if the area is not otherwise baited.

This distinction is important primarily for wildlife food plots where seed or grain is not harvested as part of a normal agricultural process. For example, if a farmer were to mow a crop without first harvesting it, that field would be considered baited for sandhill crane, but it would not be considered baited for other upland game species or wild turkey.

Using dogs to hunt

Utah Admin. Rules R657-6-20, R657-9-30 and R657-54a-13

Dogs may be used off leash to locate and retrieve migratory game birds, upland game or turkey during open hunting seasons.

Although dogs are generally allowed on state wildlife and waterfowl management areas (WMAs), they are prohibited on many WMAs from March 10 to August 31 or as posted by the DWR. Here’s a complete list of WMAs and other DWR-managed lands that are seasonally closed to dogs:

- Annabella
- Bear River (Trenton Property Parcel)
- Bicknell Bottoms
- Blue Lake
- Browns Park
- Bud Phelps
- Clear Lake
- Desert Lake
- Farmington Bay
- Harold S. Crane
- Hatt’s Ranch
- Howard Slough
- Huntington
- James Walter Fitzgerald
- Kevin Conway
- Locomotive Springs
- Manti Meadows
- Mills Meadow
- Montes Creek
- Nephi
- Ogden Bay
- Pahvant
- Public Shooting Grounds
- Redmond Marsh
- Richfield
- Roosevelt
- Salt Creek
- Scott and Norma Matheson Wetlands Preserve
- Stewart Lake
- Timpie Springs
- Topaz Slough
- Utah Lake Wetland Preserve
- Vernal Game Farm
- Willard Bay

Hunting dog field trials and training

Utah Admin. Rule R657-04

Many hunting dog field trialers and trainers want to use game birds (waterfowl or upland game) in their dog-related pursuits.

To use live game birds in dog field trials and training, you must follow certain rules and regulations. Those rules are available at any division office or in *Utah Admin.*

Rule R657-46 at wildlife.utah.gov/rules.

Important: Dog training is prohibited near sage-grouse and sharp-tailed grouse leks (breeding sites) from March 1 to May 31.

Live decoys

50 CFR 20.21 (f) and Utah Admin. Rules R657-9-16 and R657-54a-8

You may **not** use live birds as decoys.

Also, you may not take migratory game birds from an area where tame or captive live ducks or geese are present.

The only exception is if the tame or captive live ducks or geese are—and have been—confined for at least 10 consecutive days before you take the migratory game birds. The area of confinement must substantially reduce the sound of the tame or captive birds' calls. It must also totally conceal the birds from the sight of wild migratory game birds.

Amplified (electronic) calls

50 CFR 20.21 (g) and Utah Admin. Rules R657-9-17 and R657-54a-8

You may **not** take migratory game birds, upland game or turkey with recorded or electronically amplified bird calls or sounds, or recorded or electronically amplified imitations of bird calls or sounds.

Waterfowl and other migratory game birds

During most of Utah's migratory game bird hunting seasons, you may not use recorded or electronically amplified bird calls or sounds, or recorded or electronically amplified imitations of bird calls or sounds. You may, however, use electronically amplified calls or sounds during the spring hunts for light geese in the Eastern Box Elder, Southern and Northern goose areas after Feb. 1, 2027, and the Wasatch Front goose area after Feb. 16, 2027. See page 65 for season dates.

Spotlighting

Utah Code §§ 23A-5-309, 53-5a-3, 53-5a-108 and Utah Admin. Rules R657-6-24 and R657-54a-16

You may not use a spotlight, headlight or other artificial light to locate any protected wildlife while having in your possession a firearm or other weapon or device that could be used to take or injure protected wildlife.

The use of a spotlight or other artificial light in any area where protected wildlife are generally found is considered probable cause of attempting to locate protected wildlife.

The provisions of this section do not apply to the use of the headlights of a motor vehicle, illuminated sight pins on a bow or other artificial light in a usual manner where there is no attempt or intent to locate protected wildlife.

In addition, these restrictions do not apply to concealed firearm carriers, provided the person is not using the concealed firearm to hunt or take wildlife.

Using falconry to hunt

Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-12 and R657-9-33

If you're interested in using falconry to hunt migratory game birds or upland game, you must obtain a hunting or combination license and a falconry certificate of registration (COR).

Using falconry to hunt migratory game birds

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-33 and R657-6-12

If you are a falconer interested in hunting migratory game birds, you must obtain the following:

- A hunting or combination license
- A HIP number
- A federal migratory game bird stamp (also called a "duck stamp")
- A falconry certificate of registration (COR)

Legal falconry hours for migratory game bird hunting are 30 minutes before official sunrise until official sunset (see the tables beginning on page 74).

The season dates, areas open, and the bag and possession limits for falconry are listed in the section beginning on page 66.

For additional information about falconry rules and requirements, and to obtain or renew a falconry COR, please see the Falconry Rule at wildlife.utah.gov/falconry.

Using falconry to hunt upland game

Falconers who are interested in hunting greater sage-grouse, sharp-tailed grouse or white-tailed ptarmigan must obtain a permit for the bird(s) they wish to hunt.

The areas open and the bag and possession limits for falconry are the same as those listed on pages 69-73 and the *Wildlife Management Area Rules* (pages 62-63).

The only differences are as follows:

- Falconers may take pheasants of either sex.

Falconry season dates for upland game are as follows:

- All upland game may be taken by falconry from Sept. 1, 2026 through Feb. 28, 2027.

Using falconry to hunt wild turkey

Utah Admin. Rule R657-54a-7

In order to hunt a wild turkey using falconry, a falconer must have a fall management harvest turkey permit and follow the same rules and boundaries that apply to those who are hunting with archery tackle, a crossbow or a shotgun.

A falconer may only release a raptor on a wild turkey during the fall hunting season listed on their permit. Using falconry to hunt a turkey during the spring is prohibited.

See the full Falconry Rule at wildlife.utah.gov/falconry.

Sitting or roosting turkeys

Utah Admin. Rule R657-54a-10

You may not take any turkey that is sitting or roosting in a tree or any structure.

Possession and transportation

Once you've taken any migratory game bird, upland game or turkey, several rules apply to the use of the game you've taken.

During closed season

50 CFR 20.32 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-19

You may **not** possess any freshly killed migratory game birds when the hunting season is closed.

Live birds

50 CFR 20.38 and Utah Admin. Rules R657-4, R657-9-20 and R657-6-15

You may **not** possess or transport live birds. You must immediately kill any bird you wound and include it in your bag limit.

A hunting license does not give you authority to possess live game birds.

Waste of migratory game birds, upland game or turkey

50 CFR 20.25, 50 CFR 20.32, Utah Code § 23A-5-314 and Utah Admin. Rules R657-6-18, R657-9-19, R657-9-21, R657-54a-15 and R657-54a-18

You may **not** waste any migratory game bird, upland game or turkey, or permit it to be wasted or spoiled. Waste means to abandon the game or to allow it to spoil or be used in a manner not normally associated with its beneficial use. For example, using the meat as fertilizer or for trapping bait is not considered a beneficial use of the meat.

In addition, you may not kill or cripple any migratory game bird, upland game or turkey without making a reasonable effort to retrieve it. Any game you've wounded must be immediately killed and included in your bag limit.

Did you harvest a banded or collared bird?

You may legally harvest banded or collared birds as long as you follow state and federal hunting regulations. If you harvested a bird with a leg band or collar, we encourage you to voluntarily report it.

Waterfowl and other migratory game birds

When you report migratory game bird leg bands at reportband.gov you will receive information about when and where the bird was originally banded. Likewise, the person who banded the bird will be notified about the harvest and where it occurred.

Upland game birds and turkeys

The DWR, Brigham Young University and Utah State University are conducting research on wild turkeys and many upland game species. If you harvest a turkey or upland game bird with a leg band or a radio transmitter, report it by calling the phone number on the band. Please provide the date and location (GPS coordinates preferred) of your harvest, and the number on the leg band. Please provide the date and location (GPS coordinates preferred) of your harvest, and the number on the leg band.

Tracking wildlife movement matters

By contributing your hunting data to these programs, you're helping researchers understand more about wildlife populations and their migration patterns. The division thanks you in advance for helping with these research projects!

E-tag option for turkey and tundra swan

Utah Admin. Rules R657-6-16 and R657-9-23

If you choose to electronically tag your turkey or tundra swan using the Utah Hunting and Fishing app, you must complete the following steps:

1. Before you go into the field, download your permit to the Utah Hunting and Fishing mobile app. (You must have Wi-Fi or cellular service to download your permit.)
2. **Important:** You must be in the location where you harvested your bird and are ready to e-tag it before you begin the “submit e-tag” process.
3. **For swans:** See page 32 for important bill measurement requirements.
4. In your Utah Hunting and Fishing app, tap on your permit, tap the “submit e-tag” button and follow the prompts to complete the e-tagging and photo upload process.
5. **New:** Completing an e-tag will fulfill your mandatory turkey or tundra swan harvest survey requirement.
6. After you complete and submit your e-tag, you will receive an electronic harvest code. You must keep this electronic harvest code in your possession.

Remember: E-tagging is currently **not** an option for sandhill crane or grouse. Learn more about this convenient new option at wildlife.utah.gov/e-tag.

Tagging requirements for grouse and turkey

Utah Code § 23A-4-709 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-16

You must tag the carcass of greater sage-grouse, sharp-tailed grouse or wild turkey immediately upon taking possession of the carcass.

To tag a carcass, completely detach the tag from the permit and completely remove the appropriate notches to correspond with the date the bird was taken. Then attach the tag to the carcass so that the tag remains securely fastened and visible.

Your tag also includes a notch that indicates the sex of the bird. You are only required to remove this notch if you harvested a turkey.

You may not remove more than one notch indicating the date the bird was taken, or tag more than one carcass using the same tag.

Reminder: You may **not** hunt or pursue greater sage-grouse, sharp-tailed grouse or wild turkey after **any** of the following has occurred:

- Shooting and retrieving the bird
- Detaching the tag from the permit
- Removing any of the notches from the tag

Tagging requirements for migratory game birds

50 CFR 20.36 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-23

If you leave your birds in the custody of another person for picking, cleaning, processing, shipping, transporting or storing, including temporary storage, or at a location to have taxidermy services performed, you must tag the birds. You must sign the tag, and it must include your address and Utah hunting license number, the total number and species of birds taken and the date the birds were killed.

If you're transporting migratory game birds that you've taken, the birds are not considered to be in storage or temporary storage, and you don't need to have a tag on them at that time.

Tagging sandhill crane and tundra swan

You must tag the carcass of a sandhill crane immediately upon taking possession of the bird.

You must tag the carcass of a tundra swan after you return to your blind, your watercraft or dry land, whichever is nearest to the point where the bird was retrieved.

To tag a carcass, completely detach the tag from the permit and completely remove the appropriate notches to correspond with the date the bird was taken. Then attach the tag to the carcass so that the tag remains securely fastened and visible.

Your tag also includes a notch that indicates the sex of the bird, but you are not required to remove this notch.

You may **not** remove more than one notch indicating the date the bird was taken, or tag more than one carcass using the same tag.

Reminder: You may not hunt or pursue sandhill crane or tundra swan after any of the following has occurred:

- Shooting and retrieving the bird
- Detaching the tag from the permit
- Removing any of the notches from the tag

Important: See page 30 for additional swan check-in and reporting requirements.

Safety tips for turkey hunters

To stay safe during the turkey hunt, follow the recommendations of the National Wild Turkey Federation (NWTf):

- Select your calling spot in open timber rather than thick brush; turkeys are hesitant to walk into thick brush.
- Select a stump, tree trunk or rock—taller and wider than you are—to lean back against while calling; this will protect your back if another hunter moves in behind you.
- Eliminate the colors white, red, orange, black and blue from your hunting outfit; these are the colors of most gobblers.
- Listen for the alarm cries of birds or squirrels; these sounds can alert you when another hunter begins moving into your area.
- When nearby songbirds or your turkey go suddenly silent, take a careful look around. There's a good chance another hunter is moving in on your bird.
- Never move, wave or make turkey sounds to alert another hunter to your location. Remain still and speak in a loud, clear voice to announce your presence.

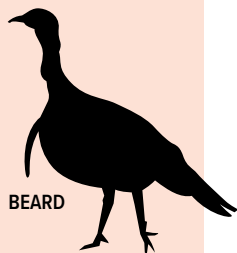
For more information, visit the NWTf's website at nwtf.org.

What is a beard?

A cluster of hair-like feathers called a beard grows from the center of the chest on male turkeys. A small percentage of hens also grow a beard.

During all turkey seasons, the head—and beard if present—of a turkey must remain attached during transport to help conservation officers confirm the sex of the bird.

Want to determine your turkey's age? Check the guide on our website at wildlife.utah.gov/uplandgame.



Upland game birds, identification requirement

Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-17 and R657-54a-12

When you are transporting any upland game bird, one fully feathered wing must remain attached to each bird you've taken. Keeping the wing attached allows wildlife officers and biologists to determine the species and sex of each bird.

When you are transporting a turkey, both the head and beard (if applicable) of the turkey must remain attached to the bird.

Migratory game birds, identification requirement

50 CFR 20.43 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-26

You may not transport migratory game birds within the United States unless the head or one fully feathered wing remains attached to each bird while you're transporting them to your home or to a migratory bird preservation facility (i.e., a facility where birds are taken to be cleaned and prepared for consumption).

Termination of possession

50 CFR 20.39 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-22

Birds that you have taken are no longer in your possession once you've delivered the birds to another person as a gift, or once you've taken the birds to a migratory bird preservation facility (i.e., a facility where birds are taken to be cleaned and prepared for consumption) or to a post office or common carrier and consigned them for transport to a person other than yourself.

Processing and taxidermy of protected wildlife

Utah Code § 23A-4-709 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-5-17

A butcher or owner/employee of a locker or storage plant may not receive the carcass of protected wildlife unless the animal is properly tagged or there is a valid donation slip.

Taxidermists must keep records of all received protected wildlife parts—including the date of receipt and documentation of the associated hunting license or permit—for at least three years.

Game bird breeders and hobbyists

Utah Admin. Rule R657-4

Because game birds in Utah are classified as protected wildlife, rules and regulations govern their possession and use. If you are interested in possessing or using live game birds, please review the rules carefully.

For more information, please visit wildlife.utah.gov/r657-4.

Shipping harvested migratory game birds

50 CFR 20.44, and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-27

You may not ship migratory game birds, unless you possess a shipping permit. Shipping permits are available from the division offices listed on page 2.

You may not transport migratory game birds, by the U.S. Postal Service or a common carrier, unless all of the following items are clearly marked on the outside of the package or container:

- Your name and address
- The name and address of the recipient
- The number and species of the birds contained in the package

Donating and transporting upland game or turkey

50 CFR 20.36, 20.37 and 20.40, Utah Code § 23A-1-205, and Utah Admin. Rule R657-6 and R654-54

The following are the only places where you may donate, or give, upland game or turkey (or their parts) to another person:

- The residence of the donor
- The residence of the person receiving upland game, turkey or their parts
- A meat locker
- A storage plant
- A meat-processing facility

You may donate, or give, harvested upland game and turkey (or their parts) to another person, as long as proper documentation of the donation is kept with the protected wildlife parts. The documentation of the donation must include:

- The number and species of the wildlife or parts donated
- The date of donation
- The license or permit number of the donor
- An image or picture of the wildlife or wildlife parts donated

Exporting harvested upland game or turkey from Utah

50 CFR 20.53 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-21, R657-6-23 and R657-54a-17

You may only export harvested upland game or turkey (or their parts) from Utah if one of the following conditions applies:

- You harvested the upland game or turkey and possess a valid license or permit corresponding to the tag.
- If you're not the person who harvested the upland game or turkey, you must obtain a shipping permit from the division.

Giving migratory game birds to someone else

50 CFR 20.40, Utah Code § 23A-1-205 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-24

You can give the migratory game birds you've taken to another person, but please remember the following:

- If you give birds to someone at any location, you must tag the birds. The tag must include your address and Utah hunting license number, the total number and species of birds you're donating, the date the birds were killed and the date the birds were donated. You must also sign the tag.
- If you accept birds from another hunter, those birds become part of your possession limit. For example, if you have 15 ducks at home in your freezer, and you accept 6 ducks from another hunter, you now have 21 ducks in your possession. That's the maximum number of ducks you can have in your possession in Utah. You'll have to eat some of those ducks before you can go hunting and take more.

Custody of another person's migratory game birds

50 CFR 20.37 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-25

You may not receive or have in your custody migratory game birds that belong to another person unless the birds have been tagged in the manner described in the previous section, *Termination of possession* on page 48.

Keep your hunting dog safe from HABs

Harmful algal blooms (known as HABs) can persist throughout the fall and winter. HABs produce toxins and pose a threat to humans and animals, especially dogs.

Important: Before you head out into the field, visit habs.utah.gov to see if HABs have been reported in the area you plan to hunt. Please be advised that active monitoring for HABs ends in October, although a HAB may be present in recreational areas.

What are HABs and how identify them

HABs form when naturally occurring cyanobacteria, also known as blue-green algae, multiply to high densities and form visible water discoloration, scum and/or mats. HABs can look like pea soup, spilled paint, grass clippings, fuzzy nodules or mucousy floating mats.

HABs can produce toxins that affect liver, nerve and skin tissue. If you suspect a HAB in the water, stay out of the water and avoid contact with any scum or mats.

Keep your dog safe

Hunters should keep their dogs away if they suspect HABs. HAB toxin exposure can be deadly for dogs! Dogs can be exposed to toxins by swimming or splashing in water experiencing a HAB. Dogs are attracted by the musty smell of HAB mats and may seek them out and eat them. Even dried HAB material may have harmful toxins present.

If you suspect your dog has been exposed to a HAB, seek immediate care from your veterinarian. Preventing exposure is the best way to protect your dog.

Preparing harvested game

Before consuming any harvested fish or wildlife from an area with HABs present, be sure to clean waterfowl and fish well with fresh water, and discard all guts.

Report HABs

Suspected harmful algal blooms can be reported to DWQ by calling 801-536-4123. Find more information about harmful algal blooms at habs.utah.gov.

Migratory bird preservation facilities

50 CFR 20.82 and 20.83 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-28

No migratory bird preservation facility (see definition on page 78) shall receive or have in custody any migratory game bird unless accurate records are maintained that can identify who each bird was received from and can show all of the following information:

- The number of each species
- The location where they were taken
- The date the birds were received
- The name and address of the person from whom the birds were received
- The date the birds were disposed of
- The name and address of the person to whom the birds were delivered

Migratory bird preservation facilities may not destroy any records they are required to maintain under this section for a period of one year following the last entry on record.

Record keeping as required by this section is not necessary at hunting clubs that do not fully process migratory birds by removing their head and wings.

No migratory bird preservation facility may prevent any person authorized to enforce this part from entering their facilities at all reasonable hours and inspecting the records and the premises where bird-processing operations are being carried out.

Importing harvested migratory game birds

50 CFR 20.61–20.66 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-29

For the complete list of rules governing the importation of migratory game birds harvested in another state or country, see wildlife.utah.gov/rules.

Here are some of the primary rules that apply:

- One fully feathered wing must remain attached to all migratory game birds being transported between the point of entry and your home or to a migratory bird preservation facility (i.e., a facility where birds are taken to be cleaned and prepared for the table).
- You may not import migratory game birds harvested in any foreign country, except Canada, unless the birds are dressed (except as required by Canadian regulations), drawn and the head and feet are removed.
- You may not import migratory game birds that belong to another person.
- Federal bag and possession limits apply, regardless of the number of states or provinces you may have hunted in during your trip. For example, if you hunt doves in two states, the total number of doves you take cannot exceed a single federal bag or possession limit. (For example, if the federal bag limit is 15 doves, and you take eight doves in the first state and then travel to another state and hunt the same day, you can take only seven doves in the second state.)

Federal bag limits for migratory game birds

50 CFR 20.11 and 20.24 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-31

Federal daily bag and possession limits apply to migratory game bird hunting, regardless of the number of states or provinces you may have hunted in during your trip. For example, if you hunt ducks in two states, the total number of ducks you take in one day cannot exceed a single federal daily bag and possession limit. (For example, if the federal daily bag limit is 7 ducks, and you take 5 ducks in one state and then travel to another state and hunt the same day, you can take only 2 ducks in the second state.)

Specific hunting methods for waterfowl

In addition to the general field regulations, there are several rules apply to the methods that you may use to hunt waterfowl and other migratory game birds in Utah.

Use of boats, and airborne and land vehicles

50 CFR 20.21(e), Utah Code § 23A-5-309 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-10

You may use a boat or motorized aquatic vehicle to hunt migratory game birds if you obey the following rules:

- Migratory game birds may not be taken from any motorboat, or craft that has a motor attached to it, unless the motor has been completely shut off and the motorboat or craft has stopped moving.
- Migratory game birds may not be taken from a sailboat unless the boat's sails are furled and the boat has stopped moving.

You may use any of these crafts under power to retrieve dead or crippled birds, but you may not shoot crippled birds from a craft if its motor is still running.

Also, you may not use any of the crafts listed above, or any type of motor-driven land, water or air transportation (including a drone), to concentrate, drive, rally or stir up migratory birds.

Avian diseases in Utah

Avian cholera, avian botulism and harmful algal blooms are diseases that primarily affect wild bird populations. Low pathogenic avian influenza is also common in migratory game birds, and usually does not cause symptoms in wild birds.

Highly pathogenic avian influenza viruses have been uncommon in the past in Utah, but there have been more widespread, multi-county outbreaks in recent years. To date, strains infectious to humans are extremely rare.

Please report dead birds: If you find a group of five or more dead birds—or any individual dead scavengers or raptors—please report the birds and their exact location to the nearest DWR office. Absolutely do not touch the birds or pick them up.

By taking some simple precautions, you can greatly reduce your risk of contracting any wildlife disease:

- Do not harvest any bird that appears sick, and do not pick up diseased birds or dead birds that you didn't shoot.
- Do not handle or eat sick birds.
- Do not allow dogs or other pets to handle or eat sick or dead birds.
- Keep your game birds cool, clean and dry.
- Wear rubber or disposable latex gloves while handling and cleaning your birds.
- After cleaning the birds, wash your hands with soap and water, and thoroughly clean and disinfect all knives, equipment, boots and surfaces that may have touched the birds with a 10-percent bleach solution.
- All birds should be cooked thoroughly (internal temperature should reach 165° F).
- Do not eat, drink or smoke while handling your birds.

Please visit wildlife.utah.gov/diseases for more information.

Airboats and personal watercraft

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-13

Air-thrust or air-propelled boats and personal watercraft are not allowed in designated parts of the following areas for the purposes of migratory game bird hunting:

- Box Elder County: Box Elder Lake, Bear River, that part of Harold S. Crane within a 1/2 mile of all dikes and levees, Locomotive Springs, Public Shooting Grounds, Salt Creek and any posted units or areas within the Bear River Migratory Bird Refuge.
- Daggett County: Brown's Park
- Davis County: Howard Slough, Ogden Bay and Farmington Bay within diked units or as posted.
- Emery County: Desert Lake
- Millard County: Clear Lake and Topaz Slough
- Salt Lake County: Blackhawk
- Tooele County: Timpie Springs
- Uintah County: Stewart Lake
- Utah County: Powell Slough and Provo River Delta
- Wayne County: Bicknell Bottoms
- Weber County: Ogden Bay within diked units or as posted, and the portion of the Harold S. Crane Waterfowl Management Area that falls within Weber County

The term "personal watercraft" means a motorboat that meets the following conditions:

- It is less than 16 feet in length.
- It is propelled by a water jet pump.
- It is designed to be operated by a person sitting, standing or kneeling on the vessel, rather than sitting or standing inside the vessel.

Boating laws and rules

If your hunting plans include a motorboat, please remember these laws and rules to ensure your safe, legal return home:

- Everyone on your boat or vessel must have a properly fitted, U.S. Coast Guard-approved life jacket. Youth 12 and younger must wear a life jacket at all times.
- Vessels longer than 16 feet must have a throwable personal flotation device immediately available.
- All motorboats, including those with electric motors, must be registered and properly numbered. **Remember:** Motorized craft must be enrolled in the Utah AIS program and have a current-year decal (see STDoftheSea.utah.gov for details).
- All motorboats must display appropriate navigation lights from sunset to sunrise. Manually propelled boats may use a white light.
- Let someone know where you are going and when you expect to return, along with your boat and vehicle license number.
- All motorboats must carry a Type B, U.S. Coast Guard-approved fire extinguisher, unless exempt.
- In addition to the equipment above, airboats operating on Great Salt Lake and adjacent waterfowl management areas must have a compass and either a flare, strobe light or other visual distress signal.

For more boating safety information, visit boating.utah.gov or call 801-538-2628.

Restrictions on motorized boats

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-12

Portions of four WMAs have been set aside for hunters who enjoy walking or paddling nonmotorized boats into the marsh. Motorized boats, which are boats with a motor of any kind, including a gas engine or an electric motor, are not allowed in the following areas:

- Clear Lake: The entire WMA
- Farmington Bay: South Crystal Unit
- Harold S. Crane: Rainbow Pond Unit and the main East Pond Unit
- Public Shooting Grounds: Wigeon Lake

Motorized vehicle access on waterfowl management areas

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-14

A motorized vehicle is a vehicle that is self-propelled or possesses the ability to be self-propelled. This does not include vehicles moved solely by human power, motorized wheelchairs or an electric personal assisted mobility device.

Reminder: Electric-assisted bicycles, propelled in part by electrical assistance, are only permitted on state waterfowl management areas if they meet the Class 1 definition provided in *Utah Code* § 41-6a-102(8) and (17).

Motorized vehicle travel on state waterfowl management areas is restricted to county roads, improved roads and parking areas.

Off-highway vehicles are not permitted on state waterfowl management areas, except in areas that are marked or posted open to their use.

Off-highway vehicles are not permitted on the Bear River Migratory Bird Refuge.

Make sure you’re in range

In the marsh, you should only shoot at birds that are within range. If you try to hit a bird that’s too far away, there’s a much greater chance the bird will be wounded or hard to find.

So, how do you know if you’re in range? Before this year’s waterfowl season opens, you can improve your ability to judge distance accurately with the following exercise:

- Find an area that’s at least 50 yards long and place four regular-sized duck decoys 20, 30, 40 and 50 yards from your starting point.

- If you don’t have four regular-sized decoys, use four pieces of cardboard cut 21 inches long by 4 inches high (the size of a medium-sized duck).
- After placing your targets, go back to your starting point, bring your unloaded shotgun to your shoulder and aim it at the target that’s 20 yards away. Notice how big your barrel looks in relation to the size of the target. Then aim at the targets that are 30, 40 and 50 yards away.

Practice this process enough, and you’ll know how birds should look when you view them over your barrel at different distances in the marsh.

Waterfowl consumption advisory

Because of elevated levels of metals and chemicals that may be present in waterfowl, hunters should check current recommendations at waterfowladvisories.utah.gov.

Waterfowl blinds on waterfowl management areas

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-34

Reminder: You may **not** construct a new permanent blind on a waterfowl management area.

You can construct and use waterfowl blinds on division waterfowl management areas (WMAs) as long as you obey the following rules:

- Waterfowl blinds may not be left unattended overnight unless they're constructed entirely of non-woody, vegetative materials that naturally occur where the blind is located.
- Live or dead-standing trees and shrubs on WMAs may not be cut or damaged unless the division gives express, written permission to do so.
- Soil or rock, above or below the water's surface, may not be excavated on a WMA unless the division gives express, written permission to do so.
- Rock and soil material may not be transported to a WMA to construct a blind.
- Waterfowl blinds may not be constructed or used in any area or manner that obstructs vehicle or pedestrian travel on dikes.

Waterfowl blinds that are constructed or maintained on WMAs in violation of the rules above may be removed or destroyed by the division without notice.

These restrictions do **not** apply to the following WMA areas:

- Farmington Bay Waterfowl Management Area—west and north of the Doug Miller Unit, Turpin Unit and Unit 1.
- Howard Slough Waterfowl Management Area—west and south of the exterior dike separating the WMA's freshwater impoundments from the Great Salt Lake.
- Ogden Bay Waterfowl Management Area—west of Unit 1, Unit 2 and Unit 3.
- Harold S. Crane Waterfowl Management Area—one half mile north and west of the exterior dike separating the WMA's freshwater impoundments from the Willard Spur.

Unattended blinds

In addition to the rules previously outlined, two other important rules apply to waterfowl blinds on WMAs and other state lands that are open to public hunting:

- Any person may use any unoccupied, permanent waterfowl blind. Waterfowl blinds on state lands are open on a first-come, first-served basis to everyone, not just to the person who built the blind.
- You cannot leave waterfowl blinds or decoys unattended overnight to reserve a spot.

Sinkbox

50 CFR 20.21(c) and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-15

You cannot take migratory game birds from any type of low-floating device that allows you to be concealed beneath the surface of the water. Called "sinkboxes," these devices float on the water, but they float barely above the water's surface. You may not hunt from sinkboxes. You may, however, hunt from other types of boxes, blinds or culverts that are attached to the bottom of the body of water where you are hunting.

Special regulations for national wildlife refuges

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-30

More than 500 refuges across the nation and the U.S. territories are included in the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service's National Wildlife Refuge System. Three of those refuges—Bear River, Fish Springs and Ouray—are located in Utah, and the following regulations apply to all.

- Current state and federal regulations apply for season dates, shooting hours, and bag and possession limits.
- Hunters may possess and use only approved nontoxic shot while in the field.
- Hunters may not enter closed areas to retrieve birds. Therefore, allow enough room between the closed area boundary and where you're hunting to retrieve your birds.
- Camping is not permitted on the refuges.
- Prohibited activities include wood cutting and gathering, littering, disturbing or removing plants or natural objects, and removing artifacts of antiquity. Shell casings and ammunition boxes are litter. Failure to make a reasonable effort to retrieve litter could result in a citation.

Maps of all three refuges are available online at wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl.

The following is specific information and regulations for each of the federal refuges in Utah:

Bear River

50 CFR 32.64

- The refuge will be open for the youth waterfowl hunt on Sept. 19, 2026.
- A map of the refuge is available online at wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl.
- Hunters may not shoot or hunt within 100 yards of refuge roads open to vehicle traffic.
- Hunters may not enter the hunting units (scout) prior to the opening day.
- Hunters may not use pits or permanent blinds. The building of a temporary blind made of natural material is permitted, but is not allowed prior to the opening day.
- Airboats are only permitted in the posted open areas of units 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 and the C blocks.
- Off-highway vehicles are not permitted on the refuge.
- Hunters may enter the refuge two hours before legal sunrise and must exit the refuge by two hours after legal sunset.
- The refuge prohibits leaving decoys, boats, vehicles and other personal property on the refuge overnight.
- Hunters may only park in designated parking areas.
- Persons possessing, transporting, or carrying firearms on the refuge must comply with all provisions of state and local law. Firearms may only be discharged according to refuge regulations (*50 CFR 27.42* and *50 CFR 32.64*).
- Archery hunting is not allowed on the refuge.
- Predator and snipe hunting are not allowed on the refuge.
- Commercial guiding and outfitter activities are not allowed on the refuge.
- All hunters entering, using or occupying the refuge for waterfowl hunting must abide by all terms and conditions listed on the refuge website.

Reminder: You can check in your swan for identification at the Bear River Migratory Bird Refuge office on Friday and Saturday only (9 a.m.–noon and 2–7 p.m.) during the 2026 hunting season.

For more information call the refuge manager at 435-723-5887 or visit bit.ly/fws_brmbrr.

Did it get wet? Decontaminate it!

When you hunt waterfowl, your boat, apparel and gear inevitably get wet or muddy. And everything from your waders and decoys to your portable blinds and boat motors will provide good hiding places for aquatic invasive species (AIS) like quagga mussels, whirling disease spores or fast-spreading watermilfoil plants.

If you're on foot, you need to complete the following steps before you leave a hunting area and walk into another waterbody.

1. Rinse all mud and debris off of your waders, boots and wetted gear or equipment.
2. Then, generously spray all of it—especially the felt soles of waders—with Formula 409 (a popular household cleaner). This treatment will kill any whirling disease spores.
3. After you return home, thoroughly clean and dry your gear before using it again.

Remember: If it floats, it's a boat! If you launch any kind of vessel—including kayaks and canoes—you must complete the annual Mussel-aware Boater course (wildlife.utah.gov/QuaggaCourse) and follow the state's clean, drain and dry requirements.

Important: Boaters using motorized vessels have additional AIS program vessel enrollment requirements and must have a current-year decal displayed on their vessel.

If you don't have time to allow your boat to dry thoroughly, you can get it professionally decontaminated. Visit STDotheSea.utah.gov to find the nearest location and schedule a decontamination.

Fish Springs

50 CFR 32.64

- The refuge will be open for the youth waterfowl hunt on Sept. 26, 2026.
- A map of the refuge is available online at wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl.
- The hunting program has expanded at Fish Springs NWR to include more species of migratory birds and new areas for upland and big game. For more information, visit the website at bit.ly/fws_fsnnwr.
- Hunters may construct nonpermanent blinds, but must remove all blinds constructed out of materials other than vegetation at the end of the hunting day.
- The refuge provides a Special Blind Area for use by hunters who are disabled. The refuge prohibits trespass for any reason by any individual not registered to utilize the area.
- The refuge allows the use of small boats, 15 feet or less, but does not allow gasoline motors and air boats.
- Hunters may enter the refuge two hours before sunrise, and must exit the refuge by 1½ hours after sunset. Hunters may not leave decoys, boats, vehicles and other personal property on the refuge overnight.

All hunters entering, using or occupying the refuge for waterfowl hunting must abide by all terms and conditions listed on the refuge website. For more information, call the refuge manager at 435-723-5887 or visit bit.ly/fws_fsnnwr.

Ouray

50 CFR 32.64

- The refuge will be open for the youth waterfowl hunt on Sept. 19, 2026.
- A map of the refuge is available online at wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl.
- Leota Bottom is the only refuge area open to duck, goose and coot hunting. Access into Leota Bottom is limited to foot, bike, canoe, rowboat or electric motorized boats. Gas-powered boats are not permitted.
- Persons possessing, transporting, or carrying firearms on the refuge must comply with all provisions of state and local law. Firearms may only be discharged according to refuge regulations ([50 CFR 27.42](#) and [50 CFR 32.64](#)). Snipe and tundra swan hunting are not allowed on the refuge.
- The use of pits and permanent blinds is not allowed. The building of a temporary blind made of natural material is permitted, but is not allowed prior to opening day.
- All hunters entering, using or occupying the refuge for waterfowl hunting must abide by all terms and conditions listed on the refuge website.
- For more information call the refuge manager at 435-545-2522 or visit bit.ly/fws_onwr.

Headed out on the water?



Digital access permit required for some WMAs

Anyone 18 years old or older must either have a **(new this year)** free digital access permit—obtainable by reviewing educational materials—or a valid Utah hunting, fishing or combination license to access waterfowl and wildlife management areas in Utah's four largest counties. This currently includes Davis, Salt Lake, Utah and Weber counties, based upon population. **If you gather shed antlers and horns, be aware of this requirement before entering a WMA in these counties.**

WMAs are primarily funded by the sales of Utah hunting, fishing and combination licenses and by federal excise

taxes (which are paid on hunting and fishing equipment)—typically, state taxes do not pay for them. All license sales go toward conservation in Utah, so having a current license is a way to support wildlife conservation, land acquisition, management and habitat restoration at your favorite WMA and statewide.

Visit wildlife.utah.gov/wmas for details about which WMAs require a permit, exemptions and more.

Thank you for supporting Utah's fish and wildlife.

What about squirrels and other nuisance mammals?

Squirrels, chipmunks, marmots and other small mammals can sometimes cause nuisance issues for homeowners.

These species are not considered upland game. If you need to remove them to resolve a nuisance or depredation issue, there are no bag limits or seasonal closures, and no license is required. Please make an effort to identify the species before you remove it—some animals are protected.

Important: Pursuit or harvest of Abert's squirrel, spotted ground squirrel and Utah prairie dog are prohibited at all times. See page 60 for additional regulations specific to prairie dogs.

Prairie dog hunting

Check the calendar and map before making plans to hunt prairie dogs.

Before you begin hunting prairie dogs, it's important to understand which species you're allowed to hunt and when you can hunt them. Utah is home to three prairie dog species:

- Utah prairie dogs in southwestern Utah
- Gunnison's prairie dogs in southeastern Utah
- White-tailed prairie dogs in northern and eastern Utah

Hunt closure—counties in southwestern Utah

You may **not** hunt Utah prairie dogs. They are protected under the Endangered Species Act and state law. Because Utah prairie dogs are the only species of prairie dog found in southwestern Utah, **all prairie dog hunting is closed year-round in the following counties:** Beaver, Garfield, Iron, Kane, Millard, Piute, Sanpete, Sevier, Washington and Wayne.

It is unlawful to pursue, hunt or kill Utah prairie dogs at any time without official federal and/or state permits or authorization. There is no recreational shooting of Utah prairie dogs.

Hunt closure—Coyote Basin

Coyote Basin, in northeastern Utah, is closed year-round to hunting of prairie dogs in order to protect the federally listed black-footed ferret. (Prairie dogs are the ferrets' primary food source.) You can find the specific boundary description for this closure in [Utah Admin. Rule R657-19-6](#).

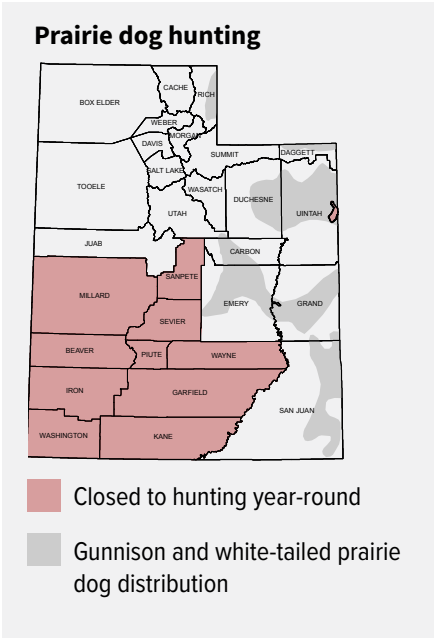
Hunt closure—seasonal

All prairie dog hunting is closed on public lands statewide from April 1– June 15, 2027. This closure protects prairie dogs while they breed and raise their litters, giving their young a better chance of survival. Remember that all national parks are closed to hunting by federal law.

Open season dates

Subject to the closures noted above, the hunting season for white-tailed and Gunnison's prairie dogs runs from June 17, 2026 through March 31, 2027.

Gunnison's and white-tailed prairie dogs causing agricultural damage or creating a nuisance on private land may be taken at any time (except in areas subject to the year-round closure described above).



ID that swan before you shoot it

Utah's tundra swan hunt closed early several years in a row because too many trumpeter swans were killed.

Only nine states offer swan hunting, and Utah is one of them. Unfortunately, the swan hunt had to close early—**four years in a row**—because hunters killed 20 trumpeter swans each season. That is the federally set limit of trumpeter swan take legally allowed each year.

As a result of these closures and the loss of hunting season opportunity for tundra swan hunters, in 2023 the Utah Wildlife Board approved a rule making trumpeter swan take illegal.

To prevent the loss of future swan hunting opportunities, hunters need to be particularly careful to identify swan species before shooting.

A mandatory orientation course

Important: The division requires anyone applying for a tundra swan permit to complete a mandatory, in-depth orientation course **each year** they apply. The course is available online at wildlife.utah.gov/swancourse and takes about 30 minutes to complete (see page 19).

The course outlines common swan hunting issues and explains the physical differences between tundra and trumpeter swans. The course also covers the rules and regulations related to tundra swan hunting. You can find those rules on pages 30-31 and in the *Field Regulations* that begin on page 33. For swan illustrations and identifying characteristics, see the waterfowl species ID section of the Utah Hunting and Fishing mobile app.

Special rules to protect trumpeter swans

Important: Taking a trumpeter swan is illegal, and criminal penalties may apply. Upon mandatory inspection, law enforcement may seize any taken trumpeter swan.

Hunters who take a trumpeter swan also incur a waiting period to apply for a tundra swan hunting permit. The timeline is as follows:

- Three years for youth
- Five years for an adult

Tundra swan permits and harvest reporting

If you obtain a tundra swan permit, there are strict regulations in place and a mandatory reporting requirement. You must submit a complete report, even if you do not hunt or harvest a swan. For details, see page 31.

If you do harvest a tundra swan, you must tag it. Any tundra or trumpeter swan must be examined by a division employee (see DWR office locations and hours on page 2) or Bear River Migratory Bird Refuge representative (Friday and Saturday only, 9 a.m.–noon and 2–7 p.m.) within 72 hours of harvest.

Reminder: Law enforcement may seize any taken trumpeter swan.

New e-tag option: See the information box on page 32 to learn more about how submitting an e-tag can fulfill the swan check in and harvest reporting requirements.

A remarkable opportunity

By making an effort to identify the species, obey swan-hunting laws and focus on tundra swan harvest, you can play an important role in maintaining future tundra swan hunting opportunities in Utah.

Wildlife Management Area rules

Utah Admin. Rule R657-6-7 and R657-6-9

Certain state wildlife and waterfowl management areas and national wildlife refuges are intensively managed for upland game and waterfowl production. As such, each area has restrictions on the use of firearms, crossbows, archery tackle and ammunition. Please use the table below to help you understand the restrictions at each area you plan to hunt.

Wildlife Management Area or National Wildlife Refuge	May discharge a firearm, crossbow or archery tackle only during open hunting seasons.*	May discharge a firearm, crossbow or archery tackle only during open waterfowl hunting seasons.	May hunt upland game, only with a shotgun using nontoxic shot and only during waterfowl hunting seasons.
Bear River National Wildlife Refuge [#]			X
Bear River Trenton Property Parcel	X		
Bicknell Bottoms [†]		X	X
Blackhawk		X	
Blue Lake		X	X
Browns Park [†]	X		X
Bud Phelps	X		
Clear Lake [‡]	X		X
Desert Lake [†]	X		X
Farmington Bay		X	X
Fish Springs National Wildlife Refuge ^{*§}	X		
Goshen Bay	X		
Harold S. Crane		X	X
Howard Slough		X	X
Huntington	X		
James Walter Fitzgerald	X		

^{*} Specified hunting seasons are authorized by the Utah Wildlife Board. You can find information about the hunting seasons in Utah's hunting and fishing guidebooks at wildlife.utah.gov/guidebooks.

[†] May hunt mourning dove with a shotgun using nontoxic shot and during the season dates listed on page 68.

[‡] May hunt mourning dove with a shotgun using nontoxic shot from Sept. 1–14, 2026.

[§] Weapons are restricted to only shotguns and archery tackle on the Willard Bay WMA and at Fish Springs National Wildlife Refuge. For details about upland game hunting at Fish Springs, visit bit.ly/fws_fsnwr.

[#] National wildlife refuges have many unique regulations. Please visit their websites and know the regulations before you hunt.

Wildlife Management Area or National Wildlife Refuge	May discharge a firearm, crossbow or archery tackle only during open hunting seasons.*	May discharge a firearm, crossbow or archery tackle only during open water- fowl hunting seasons.	May hunt upland game, only with a shotgun using nontoxic shot and only during waterfowl hunt- ing seasons.
Kevin Conway	X		
Locomotive Springs	X		X
Manti Meadows	X		X
Mills Meadows		X	X
Montes Creek	X		
Nephi	X		
Ogden Bay		X	X
Ouray National Wildlife Refuge #			X
Pahvant	X		
Powell Slough		X	X
Provo River Delta		X	X
Public Shooting Grounds		X	X
Redmond Marsh †	X		
Richfield	X		
Salt Creek		X	X
Scott and Norma Matheson Wetland Preserve	X		X
Stewart Lake †	X		X
Timpie Springs		X	X
Utah Lake Wetland Preserve †			X
Vernal Game Farm	X		
Willard Bay §	X		

* Specified hunting seasons are authorized by the Utah Wildlife Board. You can find information about the hunting seasons in Utah's hunting and fishing guidebooks at wildlife.utah.gov/guidebooks.

† May hunt mourning dove with a shotgun using nontoxic shot and during the season dates listed on page 68.

‡ May hunt mourning dove with a shotgun using nontoxic shot from Sept. 1–14, 2026.

§ Weapons are restricted to only shotguns and archery tackle on the Willard Bay WMA and at Fish Springs National Wildlife Refuge. For details about upland game hunting at Fish Springs, visit bit.ly/fws_fsnwr.

National wildlife refuges have many unique regulations. Please visit their websites and know the regulations before you hunt.

Migratory game birds: Season dates, bag and possession limits, and hunting areas

Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-31

Ducks, mergansers and coots

Northern zone season dates

- **Youth Waterfowl Hunt:** Sept. 19, 2026
- **Ducks, mergansers and coots:** Oct. 3, 2026 – Jan. 16, 2027
- **Scaup:** Oct. 3–Dec. 27, 2026

Southern zone season dates

- **Youth Waterfowl Hunt:** Sept. 26, 2026
- **Ducks, mergansers and coots:** Oct. 10, 2026–Jan. 23, 2027
- **Scaup:** Oct. 30, 2026 – Jan. 23, 2027

Ducks and mergansers

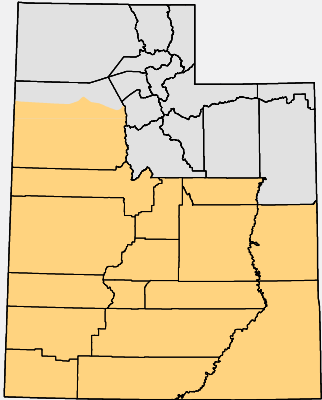
- **Daily bag limit:** 7 birds, **except no more than:**
 - › 2 canvasbacks
 - › 2 hen mallards
 - › 3 pintail
 - › 2 redheads
 - › 2 wood ducks
 - › 2 scaup
- **Possession limit:** three times the daily bag limit

Coots

- **Daily bag limit:** 25
- **Possession limit:** 75

Duck zone

For maps and boundary descriptions visit hunt.utah.gov.



□ Northern zone □ Southern zone

**Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.*

Geese

Dark geese (cackling, Canada and brant) and white-fronted geese)

Eastern Box Elder goose

- **Youth waterfowl hunt:** Sept. 19, 2026
- **Season dates:** Oct. 3, 2026–Jan. 16, 2027

Northern goose area

- **Youth waterfowl hunt:** Sept. 19, 2026
- **Season dates:** Oct. 3–10, 2026 and Oct. 26, 2026–Jan. 31, 2027

Southern goose area

- **Youth waterfowl hunt:** Sept. 26, 2026
- **Season dates:** Oct. 10, 2026–Jan. 23, 2027

Wasatch Front goose area

- **Youth waterfowl hunt:** Sept. 19, 2026
- **Season dates:** Oct. 3–10, 2026 and Nov. 10, 2026–Feb. 15, 2027

Dark geese bag and possession limits

- **Daily bag limit:** 5
- **Possession limit:** 15

White-fronted geese bag and possession limits

- **Daily bag limit:** 6
- **Possession limit:** 18

Light geese (snow, blue and Ross's)

Eastern Box Elder, Northern and Wasatch Front goose area

- **Season dates:** Oct. 15–Dec. 22, 2026 and Feb. 1–March 10, 2027

Southern goose area season dates

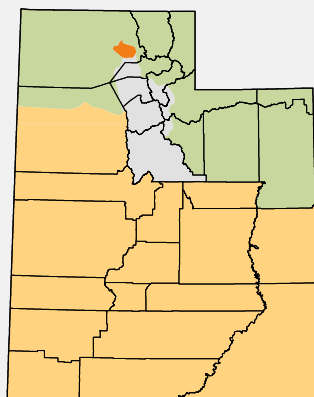
- **Season dates:** Oct. 26–Dec. 15, 2026 and Jan. 15–March 10, 2027
- **Closures:** The Bear River, Fish Springs and Ouray national wildlife refuges and the Brown's Park, Desert Lake, Farmington Bay, Harold S. Crane, Howard Slough, Locomotive Springs, Ogden Bay, Public Shooting Grounds and Salt Creek waterfowl management areas (WMAs) will be closed to light goose hunting for the season, starting on the last day of the dark goose hunt within their respective goose areas. Maps of Utah's WMAs and national wildlife refuges are available at wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl. Millard County is closed to light goose hunting Feb. 15–28, 2027.

Light geese bag and possession limits

- **Daily bag limit:** 20
- **Possession limit:** 60

Goose areas

For maps and boundary descriptions visit hunt.utah.gov.



- Eastern Box Elder
- Wasatch
- Northern
- Southern

*Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • **Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.**

Rails

No open season.

Snipe

Northern zone

- **Season dates:** Oct. 3, 2026–Jan. 16, 2027

Southern zone

- **Season dates:** Oct. 10, 2026–Jan. 23, 2027

Snipe bag and possession limits

- **Daily bag limit:** 8
- **Possession limit:** 24

Falconry: waterfowl hunting

Ducks, mergansers, geese, coots and snipes

- **Season dates:** All season dates that apply to traditional waterfowl hunters also apply to falconers. (See page 44 or the season dates beginning on page 64.)
- **Youth Waterfowl Hunt:** Falconers must be 17 years old or younger on July 31, 2026.

Falconry waterfowl bag and possession limits:

- **Daily bag limit:** 3 birds
- **Possession limit:** 9 birds (singly or in combination)

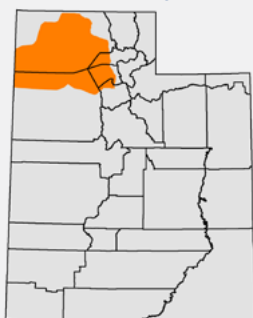
**Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.*

Tundra swan

- **Application dates:** June 30–July 14, 2026.
Use hunt number **TS1000** to apply.
- **Mandatory online course:** You must complete a **mandatory swan orientation course each year** prior to submitting an application. See page 19 or wildlife.utah.gov/waterfowl for details.
- **Permit requirement:** You must have a valid tundra swan permit to hunt swans, regardless of your age. The holder of a tundra swan permit may take and possess only one tundra swan during the 2026 season.
- **Youth Waterfowl Hunt:** Sept. 19, 2026
- **Season dates:** Oct. 3–Dec. 13, 2026
- **Immediate season closure:** If the division's monitoring program indicates that 20 trumpeter swans have been taken (meeting the federally set quota to close the hunt), the season will be closed immediately and the division will notify all permit holders.
- **Areas open:** Boundary maps are available online at hunt.utah.gov.
- **Important:** Intentionally or accidentally harvested trumpeter swans will be seized by law enforcement, and criminal penalties may apply. Hunters who harvest a trumpeter swan have a waiting period before they can apply for another tundra swan permit, which is three years for youth and five years for an adult.
- **Note:** To apply for a preference point, use the code **SWN** in your online application.
- **Falconry:** Falconry season dates, possession limits and permit requirements are the same as those for other hunters. See page 44 for details.

Tundra swan zone

For maps and boundary descriptions visit hunt.utah.gov.



■ Tundra swan area □ No hunting

American crow

- **Season dates:** Sept. 1–30, 2026 and Dec. 1, 2026–Feb. 28, 2027
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Closures:** All national wildlife refuges in Utah are closed to crow hunting.
- **Daily bag limit:** 10
- **Possession limit:** 30

Band-tailed pigeon

- **Season dates:** Sept. 1–14, 2026
- **Falconry season dates:** Sept. 1–Dec. 16, 2026
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 2
- **Possession limit:** 6
- **Falconry:** bag limit 2, possession limit 6
- **Permit requirement:** A free permit is required to participate in this hunt.

*Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • **Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.**

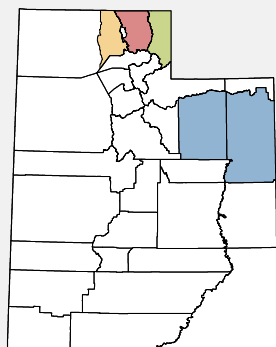
Mourning dove and white-winged dove

- **Season dates:** Sept. 1–Oct. 30, 2026
- **Falconry season dates:** Sept. 1–Dec. 16, 2026
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 15
- **Possession limit:** 45
- **Falconry:** bag limit 3, possession limit 9
- **Note:** Limits singly or in combination. Collared-doves should remain fully feathered so they can be distinguished from mourning and white-winged doves.

Sandhill crane

- **Application dates:** June 30–July 14, 2026. Use code **SC1001** for Cache County, code **SC1002** for Rich County, or for the Uintah Basin Zone, codes **SC1006** (early), **SC1007** (middle), or **SC1008** (late).* See hunt.utah.gov for boundary maps.
- **Season dates:**
 - Cache and Rich counties: Sept. 5–13, 2026
 - East Box Elder County: Sept. 5–Nov. 3, 2026
 - Uintah Basin Zone:
 - Sept. 26–Oct. 15, 2026
 - Oct. 16–Nov. 4, 2026
 - Nov. 5–Nov. 24, 2026
- **Areas open:** Cache County (**SC1001**), Rich County (**SC1002**), and the Uintah Basin Zone (**Uintah and Duchesne counties, and Ouray National Wildlife Refuge**), for which there are three hunts: early (**SC1006**), middle (**SC1007**) and late (**SC1008**).* Boundary maps are available online at hunt.utah.gov.
- **Permit requirement:** A sandhill crane permit is required to participate in this hunt. During the season, you may take only one bird of either sex.
- **Note:** To apply for a preference point, use the code **CRA** in your online application.
- **Falconry:** Falconry season dates, possession limits and permit requirements are the same as those for other hunters.
- **Closures:** Harold Crane, Public Shooting Grounds and Salt Creek WMAs are closed to sandhill crane hunting, except during open waterfowl hunting seasons. Bear River Migratory Bird Refuge is closed to sandhill crane hunting.

Sandhill crane (Found statewide)



- | | |
|--|--|
|  Cache |  Rich |
|  East Box Elder |  Uintah Basin |

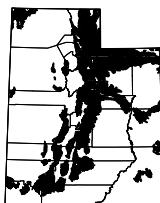
*Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • **Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.**

Upland game and turkey: Season dates, bag and possession limits, and hunting areas

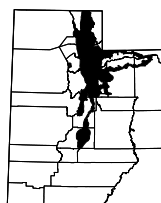
Grouse hunts

Dusky and ruffed grouse

- **Season dates:** Sept. 1–Dec. 31, 2026
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 4 birds
- **Possession limit:** 12 birds
- **Note:** Limits singly or in combination.



Dusky grouse

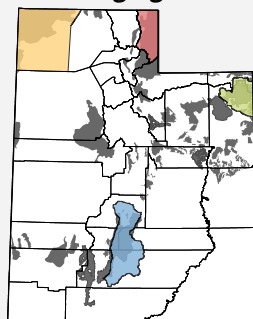


Ruffed grouse

Greater sage-grouse

- **Season dates:** Sept. 26–Oct. 18, 2026
- **Areas open:** Diamond, Blue Mountain (**SG1000**); Parker Mountain (**SG1001**); Rich County (**SG1002**) and West Box Elder County (**SG1003**).* See boundary maps at hunt.utah.gov.
- **Permit requirement:** A greater sage-grouse permit is required to participate in this hunt. Only 2 birds of either sex may be taken during the entire season.
- **Note:** To apply for a preference point, use the code **SAG** in your online application.

Greater sage-grouse

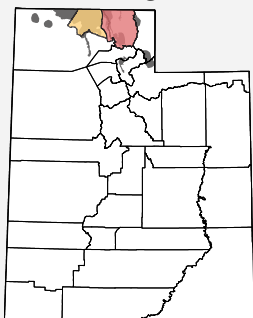


- Diamond, Blue Mountain
- Parker Mountain
- Rich County
- West Box Elder County

Sharp-tailed grouse

- **Season dates:** Sept. 26–Oct. 18, 2026
- **Areas open:** Northeast Box Elder County (**ST1000**) and Cache County (**ST1001**).* See boundary maps at hunt.utah.gov.
- **Permit requirement:** A sharp-tailed grouse permit is required to participate in this hunt. Only 2 birds of either sex may be taken during the entire season.
- **Note:** **This hunt is comprised of all or largely private property.** Hunters should ideally acquire written permission from the landowner before obtaining a permit for this hunt. To apply for a preference point, use the code **SHA** in your online application. Permits will be mailed alongside a voluntary option to assist with a genetic study.

Sharp-tailed grouse

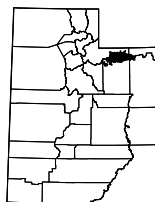


- Cache County
- Box Elder County

*Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • **Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.**

White-tailed ptarmigan

- **Season dates:** Sept. 1–Oct. 31, 2026
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Permit requirement:** A free white-tailed ptarmigan permit is required to participate in this hunt.
- **Daily bag limit:** 4 birds
- **Possession limit:** 12 birds



White-tailed ptarmigan

Wild turkey hunts

Fall turkey management harvest hunts

- **Season dates:** Oct. 1, 2026–Feb. 28, 2027 (Northern, Central, Southeastern and Southern regions)
- **Areas open:** Select areas within the Northern, Central, Southeastern and Southern regions. **This hunt is comprised of all or largely private property.** Hunters should ideally acquire written permission from the landowner before obtaining a permit for this hunt. See boundary maps in the Utah Hunt Planner at hunt.utah.gov. Mapped boundaries include private lands only within defined boundary unless otherwise specified in the Hunt Planner description.
- **Permit requirement:** A wild turkey permit is required to participate in this hunt.
- **Reminder:** A hunter may obtain three total fall management harvest permits, which may include two beardless permits and one either-sex permit per hunter. **You may obtain only one either-sex turkey permit.**
- **Important:** Fall turkey hunts are designed first and foremost to reduce nuisance turkey populations in targeted areas and address conflicts between turkeys and landowners. For this reason, female harvest is encouraged and permits are set to achieve this goal.
- **Note:** Permits for the fall 2026 turkey management harvest hunts (beardless) will be available starting Sept. 10, 2026 at wildlife.utah.gov and from license agents and division offices. See page 29 for details. To apply for a preference point, use the code **SHA** in your online application.

*Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • **Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.**

Limited-entry turkey hunts

- **Season dates:** April 10–29, 2027
- **Areas open*:** Central (**TK1003**), Northeastern (**TK1004**), Northern (**TK1005**), Southeastern (**TK1006**) and Southern (**TK1007**) areas. See boundary maps at hunt.utah.gov.
- **Permit requirement:** The limited-entry hunt requires a wild turkey permit distributed through Utah's turkey drawing. See page 25 for details. You may take only 1 bearded turkey within the season and the unit listed on your permit.
- **Note:** To apply for a bonus point, use the code **TKY** in your online application. If you are a youth with a limited-entry permit and you don't harvest during the limited-entry season, you may continue to hunt during the youth hunt and the spring general-season hunt.

Spring general-season turkey hunts

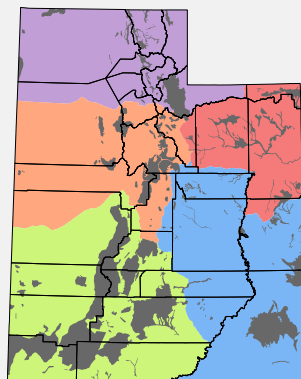
- **Season dates:** May 3–31, 2027
- **Youth hunt:** Apr. 30–May 2, 2027. For details, see page 28.
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Permit requirement:** The spring general-season hunt requires a wild turkey permit that you can purchase over the counter. See page 29 for more information. You may take only 1 bearded turkey within the season on your permit.

CWMU turkey hunts

- **Season dates:** The Utah Wildlife Board establishes the timeframe for turkey hunting on CWMUs, which runs from April 10–May 31, 2027. Within this timeframe, the CWMU operator allows at least five hunting days. If you draw a permit, it is your responsibility to contact the CWMU operator to confirm your season dates.
- **Areas open:** Pahvant Ensign (**TK1018**) and East Zion (**TK1021**). Visit hunt.utah.gov for maps and contact information.
- **Permit requirement:** The CWMU hunt requires a wild turkey permit distributed through Utah's turkey drawing. See page 23 for details. During the hunting period established by the CWMU operator, you may take only 1 bearded turkey.

Wild turkey

(colors show limited-entry boundaries)



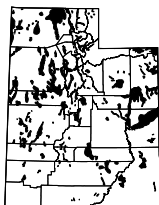
- Northern area
- Central area
- Northeastern area
- Southern area
- Southeastern area

*Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • **Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.**

Partridge and pheasant hunts

Chukar partridge

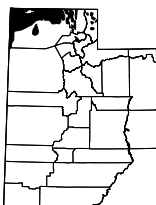
- **Season dates:** Sept. 26, 2026–Feb. 15, 2027
- **Youth hunt:** Sept. 19–21, 2026. For details, see page 15.
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 5 birds
- **Possession limit:** 15 birds
- **Note:** Antelope Island is closed to all upland game hunting.



Chukar partridge

Gray (Hungarian) partridge

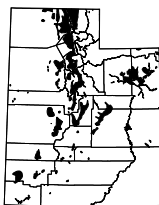
- **Season dates:** Sept. 26, 2026–Feb. 15, 2027
- **Youth hunt:** Sept. 19–21, 2026. For details, see page 15.
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 5 birds
- **Possession limit:** 15 birds



Gray partridge

Ring-necked pheasant

- **Season dates:** Nov. 7–Dec. 6, 2026
- **Youth hunt:** Oct. 31–Nov. 5, 2026. For details, see page 15.
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 2 male birds
- **Possession limit:** 6 male birds
- **Note:** Only males may be harvested. The Goshen Warm Springs WMA in Utah County is closed to all hunting.
- **Closures:** Some areas are closed to the general public each year for sponsored, organized youth and beginner pheasant hunts. Closures this year:
 - Oct. 31—Gordon Creek WMA (upper fields)
 - Nov. 14—Annabella, Pahvant and Pine Canyon WMAs, and a portion of the Ogden Bay WMA. See wildlife.utah.gov/uplandgame/youth for details.

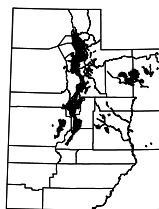


Ring-necked pheasant

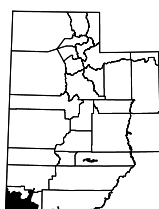
Quail hunts

California and Gambel's quail

- **Season dates:** Nov. 7–Dec. 31, 2026
- **Youth hunt:** Oct. 31–Nov. 2, 2026.
For details, see page 15.
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Bag limit:** 5 birds
- **Possession limit:** 15 birds
- **Note:** Limits singly or in combination.



California quail



Gambel's quail

Scaled quail

- **Season dates and daily bag limit:** Closed statewide

*Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • **Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.**

Rabbit hunts

Cottontail rabbit (desert and mountain)

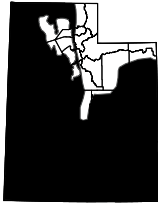
- **Season dates:** Sept. 1, 2026–Feb. 28, 2027
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 10 rabbits
- **Possession limit:** 30 rabbits



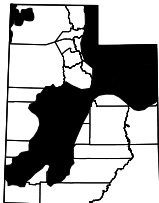
Cottontail rabbit

Jackrabbit (black-tailed and white-tailed)

- **Season dates:** Year round
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** No limit
- **Possession limit:** No limit
- **Notes:** May be hunted without a license, using any weapon that you lawfully possess.



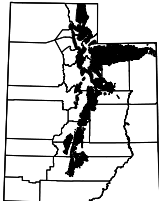
Black-tailed jackrabbit



White-tailed jackrabbit

Snowshoe hare

- **Season dates:** Sept. 1, 2026–March 15, 2027
- **Areas open:** Statewide*
- **Daily bag limit:** 5 hares
- **Possession limit:** 15 hares



Showshoe hare

**Excludes closed areas and Native American trust lands • Bold indicates areas of special note or significant changes.*

Shooting hours

Utah Admin. Rules R657-9-10 and R657-9-11

Shooting hour rules apply statewide, even on opening day.

Official sunrise and sunset times are different, depending on the day and your location. Please consult the time zone map on this page to learn the differences. **Remember:** Subtract 30 minutes from the time of official sunrise to determine when you can start shooting.

Waterfowl and other migratory game birds

- Shooting hours for all waterfowl and migratory game birds begin 30 minutes before official sunrise.
- Shooting hours end at official sunset.
- There is not a later start time for Utah's urban counties on the day of the waterfowl opener.

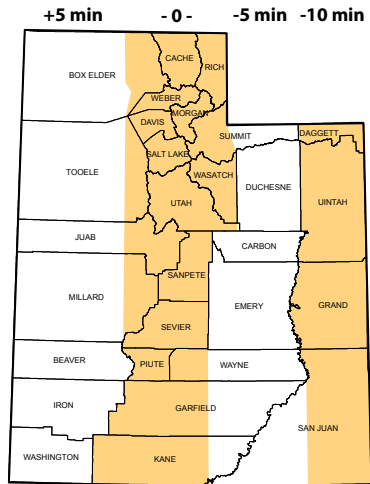
Upland game and turkey

- Shooting hours for all upland game species begin 30 minutes before official sunrise.
- Shooting hours end 30 minutes after official sunset.

For all waterfowl, upland game and turkey

Additional shooting-hour rule: You may not take wildlife or discharge any firearm, crossbow or archery tackle on state-owned lands adjacent to the Great Salt Lake, on division-controlled WMAs or on federal refuges between official sunset and 30 minutes before official sunrise.

Time zone map



Shooting hours are based on the latitude and longitude of Salt Lake City.

	September 2026		October 2026		November 2026		December 2026		January 2027	
Date	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.
1	6:55	8:00	7:24	7:09	6:58	5:23	7:33	5:01	7:52	5:11
2	6:56	7:58	7:25	7:08	6:59	5:22	7:34	5:00	7:52	5:12
3	6:57	7:56	7:26	7:06	7:00	5:21	7:35	5:00	7:52	5:12
4	6:58	7:55	7:27	7:04	7:02	5:20	7:36	5:00	7:52	5:13
5	6:59	7:53	7:28	7:03	7:03	5:19	7:36	5:00	7:52	5:14
6	7:00	7:51	7:29	7:01	7:04	5:18	7:37	5:00	7:52	5:15
7	7:01	7:50	7:30	6:59	7:05	5:17	7:38	5:00	7:52	5:16
8	7:02	7:48	7:31	6:58	7:06	5:16	7:39	5:00	7:52	5:17
9	7:03	7:46	7:33	6:56	7:08	5:15	7:40	5:00	7:51	5:18
10	7:03	7:45	7:34	6:55	7:09	5:14	7:41	5:00	7:51	5:19
11	7:04	7:43	7:35	6:53	7:10	5:13	7:42	5:00	7:51	5:20

September 2026			October 2026		November 2026		December 2026		January 2027	
Date	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.
12	7:05	7:41	7:36	6:52	7:11	5:12	7:43	5:00	7:51	5:21
13	7:06	7:40	7:37	6:50	7:12	5:11	7:43	5:00	7:50	5:22
14	7:07	7:38	7:38	6:48	7:13	5:10	7:44	5:01	7:50	5:24
15	7:08	7:36	7:39	6:47	7:15	5:09	7:45	5:01	7:50	5:25
16	7:09	7:35	7:40	6:45	7:16	5:08	7:45	5:01	7:49	5:26
17	7:10	7:33	7:41	6:44	7:17	5:08	7:46	5:01	7:49	5:27
18	7:11	7:31	7:42	6:42	7:18	5:07	7:47	5:02	7:48	5:28
19	7:12	7:29	7:43	6:41	7:19	5:06	7:47	5:02	7:48	5:29
20	7:13	7:28	7:44	6:39	7:20	5:06	7:48	5:03	7:47	5:30
21	7:14	7:26	7:46	6:38	7:22	5:05	7:48	5:03	7:47	5:32
22	7:15	7:24	7:47	6:37	7:23	5:04	7:49	5:04	7:46	5:33
23	7:16	7:23	7:48	6:35	7:24	5:04	7:49	5:04	7:45	5:34
24	7:17	7:21	7:49	6:34	7:25	5:03	7:50	5:05	7:44	5:35
25	7:18	7:19	7:50	6:32	7:26	5:03	7:50	5:05	7:44	5:36
26	7:19	7:18	7:51	6:31	7:27	5:02	7:50	5:06	7:43	5:38
27	7:20	7:16	7:52	6:30	7:28	5:02	7:51	5:07	7:42	5:39
28	7:21	7:14	7:53	6:28	7:29	5:02	7:51	5:08	7:41	5:40
29	7:22	7:13	7:55	6:27	7:30	5:01	7:51	5:08	7:40	5:41
30	7:23	7:11	7:56	6:26	7:32	5:01	7:51	5:09	7:40	5:43
31			7:57	6:25			7:52	5:10	7:39	5:44

Sunrise and sunset times courtesy of the Global Monitoring Laboratory, gml.noaa.gov.

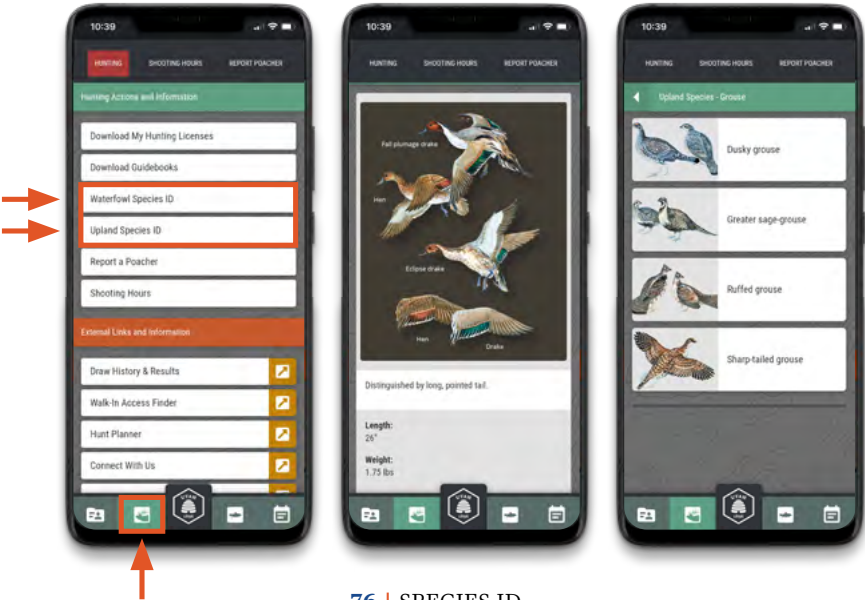
February 2027			March 2027		April 2027		May 2027	
Date	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.
1	7:38	5:45	7:02	6:19	7:11	7:52	6:26	8:24
2	7:37	5:46	7:00	6:20	7:10	7:53	6:25	8:25
3	7:36	5:48	6:59	6:21	7:08	7:54	6:24	8:26
4	7:35	5:49	6:57	6:22	7:06	7:55	6:22	8:27
5	7:34	5:50	6:55	6:23	7:05	7:56	6:21	8:28
6	7:33	5:51	6:54	6:24	7:03	7:58	6:20	8:29
7	7:31	5:52	6:52	6:25	7:01	7:59	6:19	8:30
8	7:30	5:54	6:51	6:27	7:00	8:00	6:18	8:31
9	7:29	5:55	6:49	6:28	6:58	8:01	6:17	8:32
10	7:28	5:56	6:47	6:29	6:57	8:02	6:15	8:33
11	7:27	5:57	6:46	6:30	6:55	8:03	6:14	8:34
12	7:25	5:59	6:44	6:31	6:53	8:04	6:13	8:35
13	7:24	6:00	6:43	6:32	6:52	8:05	6:12	8:36
14	7:23	6:01	7:41	7:33	6:50	8:06	6:11	8:37
15	7:22	6:02	7:39	7:34	6:49	8:07	6:10	8:38
16	7:20	6:03	7:38	7:35	6:47	8:08	6:09	8:39

February 2027			March 2027		April 2027		May 2027	
Date	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.	Sunrise A.M.	Sunset P.M.
17	7:19	6:05	7:36	7:36	6:46	8:09	6:09	8:40
18	7:18	6:06	7:34	7:37	6:44	8:10	6:08	8:41
19	7:16	6:07	7:33	7:39	6:43	8:11	6:07	8:42
20	7:15	6:08	7:31	7:40	6:41	8:12	6:06	8:43
21	7:13	6:09	7:29	7:41	6:40	8:13	6:05	8:44
22	7:12	6:11	7:28	7:42	6:38	8:14	6:04	8:45
23	7:11	6:12	7:26	7:43	6:37	8:15	6:04	8:45
24	7:09	6:13	7:24	7:44	6:36	8:16	6:03	8:46
25	7:08	6:14	7:23	7:45	6:34	8:18	6:02	8:47
26	7:06	6:15	7:21	7:46	6:33	8:19	6:02	8:48
27	7:05	6:16	7:19	7:47	6:31	8:20	6:01	8:49
28	7:03	6:18	7:18	7:48	6:30	8:21	6:00	8:50
29			7:16	7:49	6:29	8:22	6:00	8:50
30			7:14	7:50	6:27	8:23	5:59	8:51
31			7:13	7:51			5:59	8:52

Sunrise and sunset times courtesy of the Global Monitoring Laboratory, gml.noaa.gov.

Species ID

Find convenient illustrations and identification tips for upland game and waterfowl species in the *Hunting Actions and Information* area of the Utah Hunting and Fishing mobile app. Learn more and download the app at wildlife.utah.gov/mobileapp.



Definitions

CFR 20.11, Utah Code § 23A-1-101 and Utah Admin. Rule R657-9-2

Bait means shelled, shucked or unshucked corn, wheat or other grain, salt or other feed that lures, attracts or entices migratory game birds.

Baited area means the direct or indirect placing, exposing, depositing, distributing, or scattering of salt, grain, or other feed that could serve as a lure or attraction for migratory game birds to, on, or over any areas where hunters are attempting to take them.

Baiting means the direct or indirect placing, exposing, depositing, distributing or scattering of salt, grain or other feed that could serve as a lure or attraction for migratory game birds to, on or over any areas where hunters are attempting to take them.

Certificate of registration (also known as a COR) means a document issued under the Wildlife Resources Code, or any rule or proclamation of the Wildlife Board, granting authority to engage in activities not covered by a license, permit or tag.

CFR means the Code of Federal Regulations.

Closed season means the days on which migratory game birds shall not be taken.

Cooperative Wildlife Management Unit means a generally contiguous area of land open for hunting small game, waterfowl or big game, which is registered in accordance with the rules and proclamations of the Wildlife Board.

Bag limit means the maximum number of migratory game birds of a single species, or combination (aggregate) of species, permitted to be taken by one person in any one day during the open season in any one specified geographic area for which a daily bag limit is prescribed.

Dark geese means the following species: cackling, Canada and brant.

Division means the Utah Division of Wildlife Resources.

Domicile means the place:

- where an individual has a fixed permanent home and principal establishment;
- to which the individual if absent, intends to return and has an actual plan, method, and means to return to the individual's domicile within six months;
- in which the individual and the individual's family voluntarily reside, not for a special or temporary purpose, but with the intention of making a permanent home; and
- is a place where the individual resides for the majority of the individual's time.

To create a new domicile an individual must:

- abandon the old domicile; and
- be able to prove that a new domicile has been established.

Drone means an autonomously controlled, aerial vehicle of any size or configuration that is capable of controlled flight without a human pilot aboard.

Falconry means the sport of taking quarry by means of a trained raptor.

Hunting means to take or pursue a reptile, amphibian, bird or mammal by any means.

Light geese means the following species: snow, blue and Ross's.

Limited-entry permit means any permit obtained for a limited-entry hunt by any means, including conservation permits and sportsman permits.

Live decoys means tame or captive ducks, geese or other live birds.

Manipulation means the alteration of natural vegetation or agricultural crops by activities that include but are not limited to mowing, shredding, discing, rolling, chopping, trampling, flattening, burning or herbicide treatments. The term “manipulation” does not include the distributing or scattering of grain, seed or other feed after removal from storage on the field where grown.

Migratory bird preservation facility means Any person who—at their residence or place of business, and for hire or other consideration—receives, possesses or has in custody any migratory game birds belonging to another person for purposes of picking, cleaning, freezing, processing, storage or shipment.

- Any taxidermist, cold-storage facility or locker plant that for hire or other consideration receives, possesses or has in custody any migratory game birds belonging to another person for purposes of picking, cleaning, freezing, processing, storage or shipment.
- Any hunting club that in the normal course of operations receives, possesses or has in custody any migratory game birds belonging to another person for purposes of picking, cleaning, freezing, processing, storage or shipment.

Migratory game birds means those migratory birds included in the terms of conventions between the United States and any foreign country for the protection of migratory birds, for which open seasons are prescribed in this part and belong to the following families:

- *Anatidae* (ducks, mergansers, swans and geese, including brant)
- *Columbidae* (doves and pigeons)
- *Corvidae* (American crow)
- *Gruidae* (cranes)
- *Rallidae* (rails, coots and gallinules)
- *Scolopacidae* (woodcock and snipe)

Motorized vehicle means a vehicle that is self-propelled or possesses the ability to be self-propelled. This does not include vehicles moved solely by human power, motorized wheelchairs, or an electric personal assisted mobility device.

Natural vegetation means any non-agricultural, native or naturalized plant species that grows at a site in response to planting or from existing seeds or other propagules. The term “natural vegetation” does not include planted millet. However, planted millet that grows on its own in subsequent years after the year of planting is considered natural vegetation.

Night-vision device means anything that enhances visible and non-visible light and includes the use of night-vision devices, thermal-imaging devices, infrared-imaged devices and other electronic devices that enhance the visible and non-visible light spectrum. Nonresident means a person who does not qualify as a resident.

Nonresident means a person who does not qualify as a resident.

Nontoxic shot means soft iron, steel, copper-plated steel, nickel-plated steel, zinc-plated steel, bismuth-tin, tungsten-iron, tungsten-polymer, tungsten-matrix, tin and any other shot

types approved by the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service. Lead, nickel-plated lead, copper-plated lead, copper and lead/copper alloy shot have not been approved.

Normal agricultural operation means a normal agricultural planting, harvesting, post-harvest manipulation or agricultural practice that is conducted in accordance with official recommendations of State Extension Specialists of the Cooperative Extension Service of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

Normal agricultural planting, harvesting or post-harvest manipulation means a planting or harvesting undertaken for the purpose of producing and gathering a crop, or manipulation after such harvest and removal of grain that is conducted in accordance with official recommendations of State Extension Specialists of the Cooperative Extension Service of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

Normal soil stabilization practice means a planting for agricultural soil erosion control or post-mining land reclamation conducted in accordance with official recommendations of State Extension Specialists of the Cooperative Extension Service of the U.S. Department of Agriculture for agricultural soil erosion control.

Northern Zone includes all of Box Elder, Cache, Daggett, Davis, Duchesne, Morgan, Rich, Salt Lake, Summit, Uintah, Utah, Wasatch and Weber counties, and the portion of Tooele County that is north of I-80.

Off-highway vehicle means any motor vehicle designed for or capable of travel over unimproved terrain.

Open season means the days on which migratory game birds may lawfully be taken. Each period prescribed as an open season shall be construed to include the first and last days thereof.

Permanent waterfowl blind means any waterfowl blind that is left unattended, overnight and that is not a portable structure capable of immediate relocation.

Permit means a document, including a stamp, which grants authority to engage in specified activities under the Wildlife Resources Code or a rule or proclamation of the Wildlife Board.

Pre-charged pneumatic air rifle means a rifle that fires a single projectile with compressed air released from a chamber built into the rifle, and be pressurized at a minimum of 2,000 per square inch from an external high-compression device (such as a hand pump, compressor or scuba tank) firing a single broadhead tipped bolt or arrow.

Possession means actual or constructive possession.

Possession limit means the maximum number of migratory game birds of a single species or a combination of species permitted to be possessed by any one person when lawfully taken in the United States in any one specified geographic area for which a possession limit is prescribed.

Resident means a person who has a domicile (fixed permanent home and principal establishment) in Utah for six consecutive months immediately preceding the purchase of a license—or application of a license, permit or tag—and does not claim residency for hunting, fishing or trapping in any other state or country.

An individual retains Utah residency if he or she leaves Utah to serve in the armed forces of the United States, or for religious or educational purposes, and does **not** claim residency for hunting, fishing or trapping in any other state or country.

Members of the armed forces of the United States and dependents are residents as of the date the member reports for duty under assigned orders in Utah if:

- the member is **not** on temporary duty in Utah and does **not** claim residency for hunting, fishing or trapping in any other state or country.
- the member presents a copy of his or her assignment orders to a division office to verify the member's qualification as a resident.

A nonresident attending an institution of higher learning in Utah as a full-time student may qualify as a resident if the student has been present in Utah for 60 consecutive days immediately preceding the purchase of the license or permit and does **not** claim residency for hunting, fishing or trapping in any other state or country.

A Utah resident license or permit is invalid if a resident license for hunting, fishing or trapping is purchased in any other state or country. An individual **does not** qualify as a resident if he or she is an absentee landowner paying property tax on land in Utah.

Retrieval zone means areas adjacent to rest areas where game retrieval is allowed but hunting is restricted.

Sinkbox means any type of low floating device, having a depression, affording the hunter a means of concealment beneath the surface of the water.

Snipe means the following species: common, Jack, pin-tailed, solitary, Swinhoe's and Wilson's snipe.

Spoiled means impairment of the flesh of wildlife which renders it unfit for human consumption.

Southern Zone includes all of Beaver, Carbon, Emery, Garfield, Grand, Iron, Juab, Kane, Millard, Piute, San Juan, Sanpete, Sevier, Washington and Wayne counties and the portion of Tooele County that is south of I-80.

Tag means a card, label or other identification device used for attachment to the carcass of any protected wildlife.

Take means to hunt, pursue, harass, catch, capture, possess, gather, angle, seine, trap or kill any protected wildlife; or attempt any of these actions.

Trail camera means a device that is not held or manually operated by a person and is used to capture images, video, or location data of wildlife using heat, or motion to trigger the device.

Transport means to ship, export, import or receive or deliver for shipment.

Upland game means pheasant, quail, chukar partridge, gray partridge, greater sage-grouse, ruffed grouse, dusky grouse, sharp-tailed grouse, cottontail rabbit, snowshoe hare and white-tailed ptarmigan.

Waste means to abandon protected wildlife or to allow protected wildlife to spoil or to be used in a manner not normally associated with its beneficial use.

Waterfowl means ducks, including mergansers, geese, brant and swans.

Waterfowl blind means any manufactured place of concealment, including boats, rafts, tents, excavated pits, or similar structure, which has been designed to partially or completely conceal a person while hunting waterfowl.

Waterfowl management area means the following properties owned or managed by the division primarily for the conservation, production, or recreational harvest of ducks, mergansers, geese, brant, swans, and other waterfowl: Bicknell Bottoms, Brown’s Park, Blue Lake, Clear Lake, Desert Lake, Farmington Bay, Fitzgerald, Howard Slough, Harold Crane, Locomotive Springs, Mallard Springs, Manti Meadows, Mills Meadows, Ogden Bay, Public Shooting Grounds, Powell Slough, Provo River Delta, Redmond Marsh, Rock Island, Salt Creek, Stewart Lake, Timpie Springs, Topaz, Warm Springs and Willard Spur.

Wild turkey as used in this rule means a wild, free-ranging turkey and does not include a privately-owned wild turkey, domestic turkey or wild-domestic hybrids.

Youth means a person who will be 17 years of age or younger on July 31.

We want to hear from you!



Wildlife Resources



Get involved in the public process!

- 1 Check the **DWR wildlife calendar** for upcoming meeting dates and agenda topics.
- 2 Review **proposals** on the division website or our YouTube channel.
- 3 Attend a **public meeting** in your region to share comments or **submit feedback online** during the public comment period.

The **Utah Wildlife Board** creates wildlife-related rules for the state. The board considers recommendations from **The Division of Wildlife Resources** and the five **Regional Advisory Councils**. Each **RAC** depends on **public feedback** for guidance on agenda items and their recommendations for the board.

Visit wildlife.utah.gov/meetings/getting-involved to learn more.



The Utah Wildlife Board meets throughout the year at the Eccles Wildlife Education Center at Farmington Bay.

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